EASTERN SAMAR STATE UNIVERSITY

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SUSTAINABILITY REPORT







5 GENDER EQUALITY

EASTERN SAMAR STATE UNIVERSITY
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SUSTAINABLE DEVELOPMENT GOALS

5.2 PROPORTION OF FIRST-GENERATION FEMALE STUDENTS

5.2.1 INDICATOR: PROPORTION OF WOMEN FIRST-GENERATION



5 GENDER EQUALITY

5.2 PROPORTION OF FIRST-GENERATION FEMALE STUDENTS

5.2.1 INDICATOR: PROPORTION OF WOMEN FIRST-GENERATION

Eastern Samar State University (ESSU) demonstrates its commitment to inclusive and equitable access to higher education by providing opportunities for women who are the first person in their immediate family to attend university. Through its admission and student access initiatives across its five campuses, the University helps address educational disadvantages and expands opportunities for women from families with limited or no previous experience in higher education.

Under the Times Higher Education (THE) Sustainability Impact Ratings methodology, the **proportion of women first-generation** is measured by dividing the number of first-generation women starting a degree by the total number of women starting a degree. All data are provided as full-time equivalents (FTE).

The metric is set to demonstrate that universities are actively supporting disadvantaged women students. It relates to **UN Sustainable Development Goal 5, particularly Target 5.1**, which seeks to end all forms of discrimination against all women and girls everywhere.

For Academic Year 2024–2025, ESSU recorded a combined **3,744 women starting a degree** across its five campuses. Of this number, **1,025 were identified as first-generation women students**, resulting in a proportion of **0.2738 or 27.38%.**

This means that more than one in four women starting a degree at ESSU were the first person in their immediate family to attend university. This finding highlights the University's role in widening access to higher education, particularly for women who may encounter socioeconomic, educational, and familial barriers to university participation.

Distribution of First-Generation Female Students by Campus

The campus-level distribution demonstrates that ESSU's commitment to supporting first-generation women students extends across its geographically distributed campuses. However, the proportion varies among campuses, reflecting differences in the educational backgrounds and circumstances of incoming female students.

Proportion of First-Generation Women Starting a Degree by Campus, AY 2024–2025

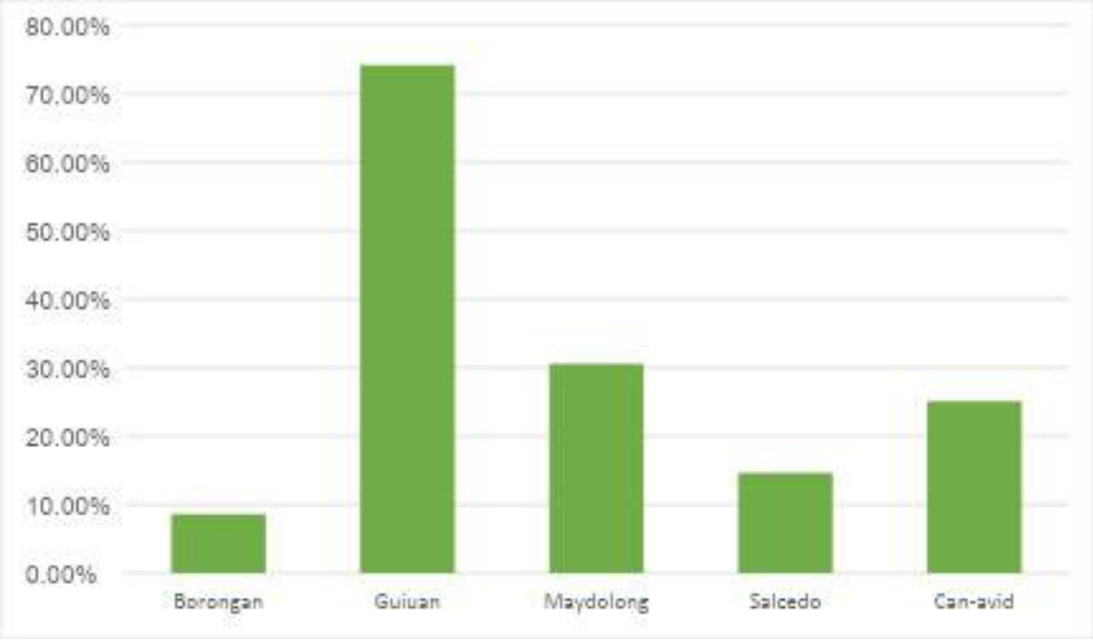
Campus	Women Starting a Degree	First-Generation Women	Proportion (Decimal)	Percentage (%)
Borongan	1,755	152	0.0866	8.66%
Guiuan	812	602	0.7414	74.14%
Maydolong	249	76	0.3052	30.52%
Salcedo	362	53	0.1464	14.64%

Can-avid	566	142	0.2509	25.09%
Total	**3,744**	**1,025**	**0.2738**	**27.38%**

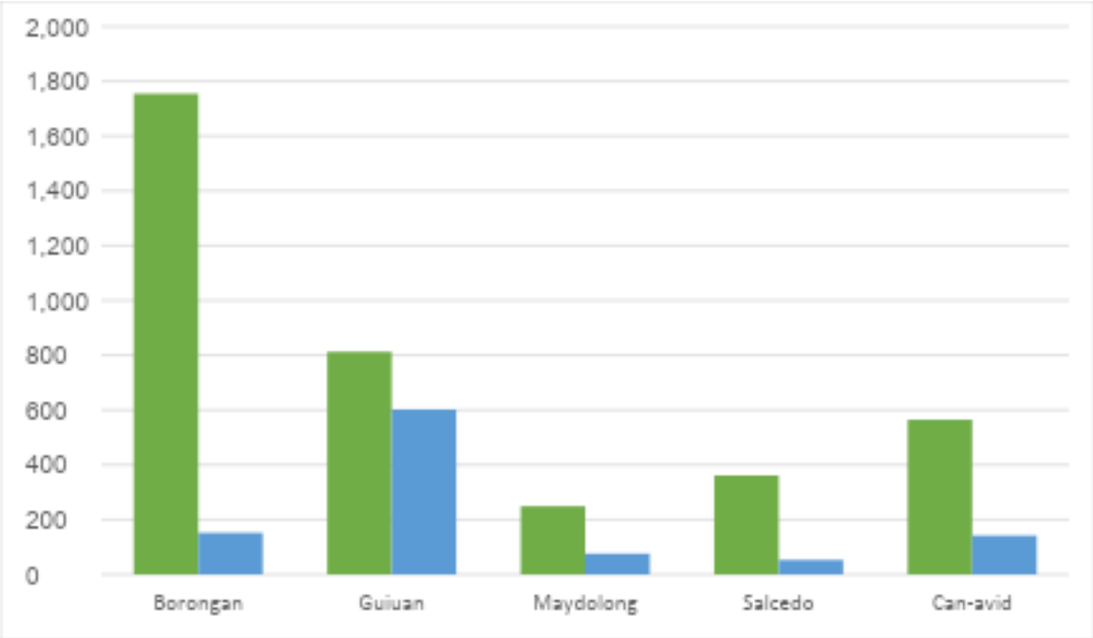
The results show that Guiuan Campus recorded the highest proportion of first-generation women students at **0.7414 (74.14%),** followed by Maydolong Campus at **0.3052 (30.52%),** Can-avid Campus at **0.2509 (25.09%),** Salcedo Campus at **0.1464 (14.64%),** and Borongan Campus at **0.0866 (8.66%).**

These differences provide useful institutional insights into the educational backgrounds of women entering ESSU's degree programs and highlight the importance of maintaining inclusive admission and student support initiatives across all campuses.

Percentage of First-Generation Women Starting a Degree by Campus, AY 2024–2025



Distribution of Women Starting a Degree According to First-Generation Status, AY 2024–2025



For Academic Year 2024–2025, Eastern Samar State University recorded **1,025 first-generation women** among 3,744 women starting a degree, resulting in a consolidated proportion of **0.2738 or 27.38%.**

The results demonstrate ESSU's contribution to widening educational participation and providing opportunities for women who are the first person in their immediate family to attend university. Guiuan Campus recorded the highest proportion at **0.7414 (74.14%),** highlighting its significant contribution to first-generation women's access to higher education.

Through its five-campus system, ESSU serves as an important avenue for women from different communities to pursue higher education, overcome intergenerational educational disadvantages, and develop the qualifications necessary for personal, professional, and socioeconomic advancement.

Moving forward, ESSU recognizes that promoting gender equality in higher education requires more than providing admission opportunities. It also requires sustained institutional support to ensure that first-generation women students can remain in university, progress academically, and successfully complete their degree programs.

Ultimately, ESSU's initiatives contribute to the advancement of SDG 5 by supporting women's equal access to educational opportunities and strengthening their capacity to participate meaningfully in society.

5.3 STUDENT ACCESS MEASURES

5.3.1 TRACKING ACCESS MEASURES

Eastern Samar State University (ESSU) – Salcedo Campus, through its Gender and Development (GAD) Office, demonstrates its commitment to ensuring women's equal access to higher education through the implementation of its **Policy on Women's Applications, Acceptance, Entry, and Participation.**

The policy establishes an institutional framework that promotes gender equality and non-discrimination in admission and participation in university programs. It specifically recognizes women's right to equal access to educational opportunities and provides mechanisms to ensure that admission decisions are based on qualifications and merit rather than sex or gender.

In direct support of the THE indicator on **systematically measure and track women's application rate, and acceptance or entry rate**, the policy identifies all female applicants seeking admission to ESSU-Salcedo programs as its target population. It further mandates that admission policies and entrance examinations shall be gender-neutral and that no applicant shall be denied entry or given preferential treatment based on sex or gender.

These provisions establish a formal basis for monitoring women's applications, acceptance, and entry into higher education. By recognizing women applicants as a specific group for institutional monitoring, ESSU-Salcedo demonstrates an intentional approach to identifying potential gender-related barriers and promoting equitable access to its academic programs.

The university also establishes clear institutional responsibilities for implementing these measures. The GAD Office shall oversee the implementation of the policy and ensure compliance across university processes, while the Admissions Office shall integrate gender-fair practices into admission procedures. Regular monitoring and evaluation shall likewise be conducted to assess the effectiveness of the policy and recommend improvements.

Beyond admission, the policy provides complementary interventions that strengthen women's opportunities to participate and succeed in higher education. These include mentorship, counseling, leadership training, flexible academic arrangements, representation in decision-making bodies, and equal access to scholarships, research grants, and training opportunities.

The impact of these measures is reflected in the university's institutionalization of gender-responsive access mechanisms. Rather than limiting gender equality to the admission stage, ESSU-Salcedo adopts a broader approach that recognizes the importance of women's participation, representation, and continuing development within the academic community.

Through this policy, ESSU-Salcedo contributes to the realization of SDG Target 5.1, which seeks to end all forms of discrimination against women and girls, and SDG Target 5.A, which promotes equal rights and opportunities for women. These commitments reinforce the university's responsibility to provide an inclusive educational environment in which women can access and benefit from higher education without gender-based discrimination.

ESSU-Salcedo's Institutional Measures Supporting THE Indicator 5.3.1

Documented provision	Evidence from the policy	Contribution to tracking women's access
Identification of women applicants	The policy covers "All female applicants seeking admission to ESSU-Salcedo programs."	Establishes the population whose applications and admission outcomes should be monitored.
Gender-neutral admission	"All admission policies and entrance examinations are gender-neutral."	Promotes equitable assessment of applicants regardless of sex or gender.
Non-discrimination in admission	"No applicant shall be denied entry or given preferential treatment based on sex or gender."	Provides an institutional safeguard against gender-based discrimination in access to higher education.
Monitoring responsibility	The GAD Office shall oversee implementation and ensure compliance in all university processes.	Assigns institutional responsibility for monitoring gender-responsive practices.
Admissions integration	The Admissions Office shall integrate gender-fair practices in admission procedures.	Connects gender equality commitments with actual admission processes.
Monitoring and evaluation	"Regular monitoring and evaluation shall be conducted to assess the effectiveness of this policy and recommend improvements."	Establishes a mechanism for assessing implementation and identifying areas for improvement.

These provisions demonstrate that ESSU-Salcedo has established an institutional framework for gender-responsive admission. The policy identifies women applicants as a specific population and assigns responsibilities for implementing and monitoring equitable admission practices.

However, the provisions do not, by themselves, establish that women's application and acceptance or entry rates are already being systematically measured. Actual admission records and monitoring reports are necessary to demonstrate this requirement.

Policy on Women's Application, Acceptance, Entry, and Participation

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POLICY ON WOMEN'S APPLICATIONS, ACCEPTANCE, ENTRY, AND PARTICIPATION

Gender and Development (GAD) Office
ESSU-Salcedo

I. Policy Statement

Eastern Samar State University – Salcedo Campus (ESSU-Salcedo) is committed to ensuring **equal access, fair treatment, and active participation** of women in all academic and administrative programs. The university upholds gender equality and non-discrimination in all aspects of admission, hiring, training, and participation in school activities.

The university recognizes women as equal partners in education and development and ensures that their rights, welfare, and opportunities are respected and promoted in all university processes

II. Objectives

This policy aims to:

1. Promote **equal access** for women to academic and employment opportunities at ESSU-Salcedo.
2. Ensure **fair admission and recruitment procedures** free from gender bias or discrimination.
3. Encourage **women's participation** in leadership roles, research, and community development programs.
4. Provide **supportive measures** that enable women to succeed in their academic and professional pursuits.

III. Scope

This policy applies to:

- All **female applicants** seeking admission to ESSU-Salcedo programs.
- All **female employees** applying for teaching, administrative, or support positions.
- **Female students, faculty, and staff** participating in university activities, research, and governance.

IV. Policy Guidelines

1. **Equal Opportunity Admission**
   - The university shall ensure that all admission policies and entrance examinations are gender-neutral.
   - No applicant shall be denied entry or given preferential treatment based on sex or gender.
2. **Fair Recruitment and Employment Practices**
   - Women applicants for faculty or staff positions shall be given equal consideration based on qualifications and merit.
   - Job postings and hiring announcements shall use inclusive and gender-sensitive language.
3. **Support and Retention Programs**
   - The GAD Office shall coordinate programs to support women's education and career development, including mentorship, counseling, and leadership training.
   - Flexible academic and work arrangements may be provided to accommodate women's needs, especially for those who are mothers or caregivers.
4. **Participation and Representation**
   - The university shall encourage women's representation in decision-making bodies, committees, and student organizations.
   - Opportunities for scholarships, research grants, and training shall be equally open to women.
5. **Awareness and Capacity Building**
   - The GAD Office shall conduct gender-sensitivity training and orientation for students, faculty, and staff to promote respect and equality.

V. Implementation and Monitoring

- The GAD Office shall oversee the implementation of this policy and ensure compliance in all university processes.
- The Admissions Office and Human Resource Unit shall integrate gender-fair practices in admission and hiring procedures.
- Regular monitoring and evaluation shall be conducted to assess the effectiveness of this policy and recommend improvements.

VI. Effectivity

This policy shall take effect immediately upon approval by the Campus Administrator and shall form part of ESSU-Salcedo's Access and Participation Plan for Gender Equality.

MARICEL A. GARCIA, RN, MoB
GAD Focal Person, ESSU-Salcedo

Noted:

MIR-I-NISA YANEZ-BOCO, Ed.D.
Campus Administrator

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SUSTAINABLE DEVELOPMENT GOALS

5.3 STUDENT ACCESS MEASURES

5.3.2 POLICY FOR WOMEN APPLICATIONS AND ENTRY



5 GENDER EQUALITY

5.3 STUDENT ACCESS MEASURES

5.3.2 POLICY FOR WOMEN APPLICATIONS AND ENTRY

Eastern Samar State University (ESSU) demonstrates its institutional commitment to promoting gender equality and facilitating women's access to higher education through its policies and institutional initiatives addressing student admission, acceptance, entry, participation, and academic support. These initiatives reflect the University's recognition of the importance of ensuring equitable educational opportunities and providing an enabling environment where women can pursue and complete their higher education.

The University's **Signed Acceptance Policy of Salcedo Campus** serves as documentary evidence of its institutional framework for addressing student applications, acceptance, and entry into higher education. The policy provides an institutional basis for ensuring that admission and acceptance processes are guided by established provisions and procedures. Its coverage of women's applications, acceptance, entry, and participation demonstrates ESSU's efforts to promote equitable access to higher education and ensure that female applicants and students are afforded opportunities to participate in university education.

Complementing this policy is the **Signed Mentoring Policy of Salcedo Campus**, implemented through its Gender and Development (GAD) Office. This policy establishes an institutional framework for mentoring and supporting female students throughout their academic journey. Through mentoring initiatives, the University provides a mechanism for guidance, encouragement, and support that can help women navigate academic challenges, strengthen their confidence, and maximize their opportunities for educational achievement. The integration of mentoring into the University's gender and development initiatives further reinforces its commitment not only to facilitating women's entry into higher education but also to supporting their continued participation and academic development.

Moreover, ESSU's commitment is reflected in the scholarship assistance extended to female students across its campuses during School Year 2024–2025. The documentary evidence attached from the Main (Borongan), Guiuan, Salcedo, Maydolong, and Can-avid Campuses demonstrates the University's implementation of scholarship programs that provide financial support to female students. These initiatives help address financial barriers to higher education and contribute to creating more inclusive opportunities for women, particularly those who may require financial assistance to pursue their academic aspirations.

Taken together, the Signed Acceptance Policy, Signed Mentoring Policy, and supporting scholarship documentation demonstrate ESSU's institutional efforts to address women's access

to higher education through complementary measures covering admission, acceptance, entry, participation, mentoring, and financial support. These initiatives are significant in advancing **UN Sustainable Development Goal 5, particularly Targets 5.1 and 5.A**, by strengthening institutional mechanisms that promote gender equality and expand opportunities for women and girls in education.

Through these policies and initiatives, ESSU underscores that promoting women's access to higher education requires more than providing admission opportunities. It also entails establishing institutional support systems that empower female students to participate meaningfully in university life and pursue their educational goals.

Policy on Women's Application, Acceptance, Entry, and Participation



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POLICY ON WOMEN'S APPLICATIONS, ACCEPTANCE, ENTRY, AND PARTICIPATION

Gender and Development (GAD) Office
ESSU-Salcedo

I. Policy Statement

Eastern Samar State University – Salcedo Campus (ESSU-Salcedo) is committed to ensuring **equal access, fair treatment, and active participation** of women in all academic and administrative programs. The university upholds gender equality and non-discrimination in all aspects of admission, hiring, training, and participation in school activities.

The university recognizes women as equal partners in education and development and ensures that their rights, welfare, and opportunities are respected and promoted in all university processes

II. Objectives

This policy aims to:

1. Promote **equal access** for women to academic and employment opportunities at ESSU-Salcedo.
2. Ensure **fair admission and recruitment procedures** free from gender bias or discrimination.
3. Encourage **women's participation** in leadership roles, research, and community development programs.
4. Provide **supportive measures** that enable women to succeed in their academic and professional pursuits.

III. Scope

This policy applies to:

- All **female applicants** seeking admission to ESSU-Salcedo programs.
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   - The GAD Office shall coordinate programs to support women's education and career development, including mentorship, counseling, and leadership training.
   - Flexible academic and work arrangements may be provided to accommodate women's needs, especially for those who are mothers or caregivers.
4. **Participation and Representation**
   - The university shall encourage women's representation in decision-making bodies, committees, and student organizations.
   - Opportunities for scholarships, research grants, and training shall be equally open to women.
5. **Awareness and Capacity Building**
   - The GAD Office shall conduct gender-sensitivity training and orientation for students, faculty, and staff to promote respect and equality.

V. Implementation and Monitoring

- The GAD Office shall oversee the implementation of this policy and ensure compliance in all university processes.
- The Admissions Office and Human Resource Unit shall integrate gender-fair practices in admission and hiring procedures.
- Regular monitoring and evaluation shall be conducted to assess the effectiveness of this policy and recommend improvements.

VI. Effectivity

This policy shall take effect immediately upon approval by the Campus Administrator and shall form part of ESSU-Salcedo's Access and Participation Plan for Gender Equality.

MARICEL A. GARCIA, RN, MoB
GAD Focal Person, ESSU-Salcedo

Noted:

MIR-I-NISA YANEZ-BOCO, Ed.D.
Campus Administrator

Policy on Women's Application, Acceptance, Entry, and Participation



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Guidelines on Women's Mentoring Program

Gender and Development (GAD) Office
ESSU-Salcedo

I. Program Description

The Women's Mentoring Program is designed to support the personal and professional growth of female students, faculty, and staff through guidance, capacity-building, and networking. It aims to empower women to develop leadership skills, build confidence, and achieve their academic and career goals.

II. Objectives

1. To provide a supportive environment where women can share experiences and learn from one another.
2. To enhance the leadership, academic, and professional capabilities of women participants.
3. To promote gender equality by encouraging women's active participation in institutional activities.
4. To build a network of mentors and mentees committed to women's empowerment.

III. Mentoring Framework

Mentor: A female professional or faculty member who guides and supports the mentee's development.

Mentee: A student or junior staff who seeks advice, motivation, and skills enhancement from her mentor.

Mentoring may be conducted through:

One-on-One Sessions: Regular personal meetings between mentor and mentee.

Group Mentoring: Sharing experiences and learning collectively in small groups.

Workshops & Seminars: Training sessions on leadership, communication,

IV. Implementation Guidelines

1. Selection of Participants – Interested mentors and mentees register through the Gender and Development (GAD) Office or designated coordinator.

2. Matching Process – Mentors and mentees are paired based on goals, field of interest, and compatibility.

3. Mentoring Agreement – A short-term plan outlining objectives, meeting schedules, and expected outcomes is prepared.

4. Regular Meetings – Pairs meet at least once a month for coaching, discussions, or goal tracking.

5. Monitoring and Evaluation – The GAD Office tracks progress through feedback forms, reflection journals, or periodic reports.

6. Recognition and Sustainability – Outstanding mentors and mentees are recognized annually to encourage continuous participation.

V. Expected Outcomes

Improved self-confidence and leadership potential among women.

Enhanced participation of women in academic, organizational, and community activities.

Strengthened culture of mentorship and mutual empowerment within the institution.

Greater awareness of gender equality and women's rights.

Link to Evidence:

Acceptance Policy - Salcedo Campus

Mentoring Guidelines - Salcedo Campus

Scholarship - Borongan Campus

Scholarship - Guiuan Campus

Scholarship - Salcedo Campus

Scholarship - Maydolong Campus

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SUSTAINABLE DEVELOPMENT GOALS

5.3 STUDENT ACCESS MEASURES

5.3.3 WOMEN'S ACCESS SCHEMES



5 GENDER EQUALITY

5.3 STUDENT ACCESS MEASURES

5.3.3 WOMEN'S ACCESS SCHEMES

Institutional Commitment to Women's Access to Higher Education

Eastern Samar State University (ESSU) demonstrates its commitment to advancing women's access to higher education through institutional programs, policies, and support mechanisms that promote gender equality, educational participation, financial accessibility, and women's empowerment.

Consistent with Sustainable Development Goal 5 (Gender Equality), particularly UN Targets 5.1 and 5.A, the University recognizes the importance of establishing an educational environment where women are afforded equal opportunities to access, participate in, and benefit from higher education.

ESSU's initiatives address three complementary dimensions of women's access:

1. Mentoring schemes – structured mentoring opportunities that strengthen women's academic development, leadership capabilities, self-confidence, and professional growth.
2. Scholarship schemes – financial assistance and educational subsidies that help women overcome financial barriers to higher education.
3. Other provision – gender-responsive student welfare, inclusive learning arrangements, health and wellness services, information dissemination, and opportunities for women's participation in university activities.

These provisions demonstrate that the University's approach to women's access extends beyond admission and enrollment. It also addresses the financial, academic, personal, and institutional conditions that enable women to participate meaningfully in higher education.

Women's Mentoring Schemes

ESSU, through the Gender and Development (GAD) Office of the ESSU-Salcedo Campus, implements a structured **Women's Mentoring Program** to empower female students through personal development, leadership enhancement, academic guidance, and professional growth.

The initiative is guided by established *Guidelines on Women's Mentoring Program*, which provide the institutional framework for its objectives, implementation procedures, mentoring approaches, and monitoring mechanisms.

The program facilitates meaningful mentoring relationships between experienced women professionals, faculty members, and female students. Through these relationships, participants

gain opportunities to acquire knowledge, develop skills, exchange experiences, and receive practical guidance relevant to their academic and future professional endeavors.

The program employs four mentoring approaches:

- One-on-one mentoring;
- Group mentoring;
- Workshops and seminars; and
- Peer mentoring.

These approaches accommodate varying mentoring needs and allow the University to reach a wider population of female students. Group mentoring and peer mentoring, in particular, enable multiple participants to benefit from shared experiences, collaborative discussions, and guidance from mentors.

The implementation process includes participant registration, mentor-mentee matching, mentoring agreements, regular mentoring sessions, monitoring and evaluation, and recognition of outstanding mentors and mentees. Mentoring pairs are expected to meet at least once a month for coaching, discussions, and goal tracking. The GAD Office monitors mentoring engagements through feedback forms, reflection journals, and periodic reports.

Link to Evidence: Women's Mentoring Program

Women's Scholarship and Financial Assistance Schemes

ESSU further promotes women's access to higher education through its Scholarship and Financial Assistance Program. The University recognizes that financial constraints can create barriers to women's entry into, continued participation in, and completion of higher education.

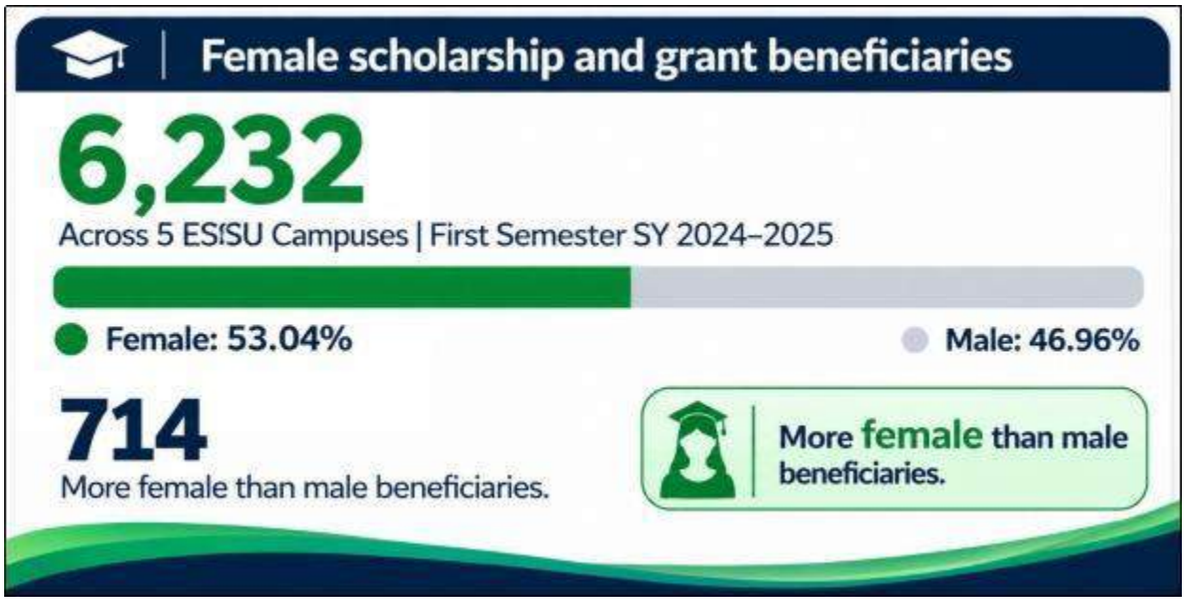
Through government-funded scholarships, educational subsidies, and private scholarship grants, ESSU facilitates access to financial assistance for qualified students without prejudice or discrimination based on gender.

Across ESSU's Five Campuses Scholarship and Assistantship Program report for the First Semester of School Year 2024–2025 provides sex-disaggregated information on scholarship and financial assistance beneficiaries as of September 19, 2024.

The report documents **6,232 female beneficiaries out of 11,750 total recorded beneficiaries,** demonstrating that women constituted the majority of students covered by the reported scholarship and financial assistance provisions.

Distribution of Scholarship Beneficiaries by Sex

Beneficiary Classification	Number of Students	Proportion
Female	6,232	53.04%
Male	5,518	46.96%
Total	**11,750**	**100%**



The figures indicate that female beneficiaries outnumbered male beneficiaries by 714 students. Women's 53.04% share of the total recorded beneficiaries demonstrates their substantial participation in the University's scholarship and financial assistance programs.

This distribution is particularly relevant to women's access to higher education because financial assistance can help reduce the economic barriers that affect students' ability to pursue and continue their studies.

Scholarship and Financial Assistance by Program

The scholarship report identifies several government-funded, private, and other educational assistance programs.

Scholarship / Grant Program	Male	Female	Total
CHED Full State Scholarship Program	0	4	4
CHED Half State Scholarship Program	4	12	16
CHED Full State Scholarship Program (GAD)	1	0	1
CHED Half State Scholarship Program (GAD)	1	3	4
Coconut Farmers and Their Families (COSCHO)	13	46	59
SUC-TDP	43	23	66
TDP-TES	137	182	319
TES Listahanan	65	121	186
4Ps-SWDI	51	204	255
DOST-SEI	7	5	12

BFAR	5	10	15
DAR	2	1	3
OWWA	4	6	10
Government scholarship subtotal	333	617	950
SMART/PLDT (Private)	5	9	14
RA 10931	5,180	5,606	10,786
GRAND TOTAL	**5,518**	**6,232**	**11,750**

The fact that female beneficiaries constitute 53.04% of the total recorded beneficiaries indicates that women represent a substantial share of students reached by the University's financial assistance mechanisms.

The difference of 714 between female and male beneficiaries further demonstrates that women are actively represented in the University's scholarship and educational subsidy programs.

These results illustrate three important contributions:

1. **Reduction of financial barriers:** Government subsidies and scholarships help women access educational opportunities despite financial limitations.
2. **Support for educational continuity:** Financial assistance helps eligible female students meet educational expenses and sustain their participation in higher education.
3. **Equal access to financial opportunities:** The availability of different scholarship categories provides multiple pathways through which women can obtain educational assistance.

The figures demonstrate beneficiary reach rather than independently establishing the effect of scholarships on enrollment, retention, or graduation. Nevertheless, they provide measurable evidence of women's participation in institutional financial assistance programs.

Other Provisions Supporting Women's Access to Higher Education

Beyond mentoring and scholarships, ESSU implements other institutional provisions that promote gender equality, inclusive education, student welfare, and women's empowerment. These provisions recognize that ensuring women's access to higher education requires an environment that responds to their academic, personal, health, social, and developmental needs.

The ESSU Student Manual serves as an institutional reference for student welfare, guidance services, scholarships, and student organizations. The University's identified provisions include the following:

Other institutional provisions supporting women's access

Area of Provision	Institutional Measures

Learning resources	Access to gender-sensitive instructional materials, library resources, and learning opportunities.
Inclusive learning environment	Recognition of the needs of pregnant students, students with disabilities, and self-supporting students.
Student participation	Promotion of gender-fair practices in student government, campus organizations, and university activities.
Health and wellness	Access to primary health care and wellness services, including information on reproductive health and gender-related concerns.
Sports and cultural development	Equal opportunities for women and men to participate in sports training, competitions, and cultural activities.
Information and orientation	Dissemination of educational, personal, career, and social information on gender-related issues and conduct of GAD orientation for students.
Financial assistance	Scholarships provided to deserving students without prejudice or discrimination.
Information dissemination	Dissemination of available scholarship opportunities through the Scholarship Office.
Equal application opportunities	Students are not denied the opportunity to apply for scholarships based on gender orientation.
Fair screening and selection	Equal opportunities for inclusion in scholarship screening and selection.
Transparency	Announcement of scholarship results through transparent processes.

These provisions establish complementary mechanisms for addressing barriers to women's participation in higher education.

Gender-sensitive learning resources and inclusive learning arrangements help create an educational environment responsive to students' varying circumstances. Health and wellness services recognize the importance of physical and reproductive health, while equal opportunities in sports, student organizations, and university activities encourage women's active participation in campus life.

Similarly, transparent scholarship processes and information dissemination help ensure that female students are informed about available financial assistance and are afforded equal opportunities to apply and qualify.

ESSU Guiuan's National Women's Month Celebration 2025

Further demonstrating its commitment to gender equality and women's empowerment, ESSU Guiuan, through its Gender and Development (GAD) Office, in collaboration with the ESSU Students' Media Organization (ESMO), spearheaded a series of activities in celebration of National Women's Month 2025.

Anchored on the theme "Babae sa lahat ng sektor, aangat ang bukas sa Bagong Pilipinas," the celebration recognized the strength, resilience, and achievements of women while promoting empowerment, inclusivity, health, and wellness.

The celebration included the following activities:

1. Women's Month Zumba

   Led by the ESSU Dance Troupe, the activity initiated weekly fitness sessions scheduled every Friday throughout March 2025. It encouraged physical fitness, recreation, and women's participation in wellness activities.
2. Free Pamper and Care Program

   Organized by the College of Technology for ESSU Guiuan women employees, this initiative provided relaxation and self-care services in recognition of women's contributions to the University.
3. Free Medical Consultation

   Conducted on March 7, 2025, through the partnership of Felipe Abrigo Memorial Hospital (FAMH) and the College of Nursing (CoN), providing free medical consultation and emphasizing the importance of women's health and well-being.

These activities demonstrate how the University's gender-responsive initiatives extend beyond formal academic support to address the broader well-being of women within the university community.

The weekly Zumba sessions promoted physical wellness and participation in recreational activities. The free pamper and care program recognized the importance of personal well-being among women employees, while the medical consultation provided an opportunity for women to access health-related services.

The collaboration among the GAD Office, ESMO, ESSU Dance Troupe, College of Technology, College of Nursing, and Felipe Abrigo Memorial Hospital also illustrates the participation of different university units and an external healthcare institution in advancing women's empowerment.

The celebration provided a platform for recognizing women's achievements, promoting gender equality, and encouraging active engagement in women's empowerment advocacy.

Although these activities primarily benefited women employees and the wider university community, they demonstrate the University's broader gender-responsive institutional environment and complement its student-focused mentoring and scholarship programs.

Link to Evidence: https://www.facebook.com/share/p/155DfJsRnvJ/

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SUSTAINABLE DEVELOPMENT GOALS

5.4 PROPORTION OF SENIOR FEMALE ACADEMICS

5.4.1 PROPORTION OF SENIOR FEMALE ACADEMICS



5 GENDER EQUALITY

5.4 PROPORTION OF SENIOR FEMALE ACADEMICS

5.4.1 PROPORTION OF SENIOR FEMALE ACADEMICS

The proportion of senior female academics is an important measure of the university's commitment to promoting gender equality, particularly in academic leadership, professional advancement, and institutional decision-making. Under the Times Higher Education (THE) Sustainability Impact Ratings methodology, this indicator is defined as **the "number of women in senior roles**, divided by the total number of senior roles in the university." Senior roles can include professorships, deanships, and senior university leaders. The methodology excludes honorary positions and requires all data to be provided as full-time equivalents (FTE).

The metric is designed to show that universities are promoting women appropriately and that their leadership reflects gender balance. It directly relates to United Nations Sustainable Development Goal 5, Target 5.5, which emphasizes women's full and effective participation and equal opportunities for leadership at all levels of decision-making.

For the 2025 reporting period, Eastern Samar State University utilized its personnel records covering permanent higher education academic employees across its five campuses: Borongan, Can-avid, Guiuan, Salcedo, and Maydolong. These institutional records provide the basis for identifying academic personnel, their respective academic ranks, and sex classifications.

For this assessment, ESSU operationally identifies senior academic staff as personnel holding the academic ranks of **Professor and Associate Professor**, covering the different levels within these classifications. Assistant Professors and Instructors are excluded from this particular computation. Only personnel entries with identifiable names and corresponding sex classifications were included in the analysis.

Based on the identified personnel in the submitted roster, ESSU has **96 senior academic staff**, consisting of **67 female academics and 29 male academics**. Women therefore account for approximately **0.6979 (69.79%)** of the identified senior academic personnel, while men account for **0.3021 (30.21%).**

This distribution demonstrates the substantial representation of women in senior academic positions at the university. Women constitute approximately seven out of every ten identified senior academic personnel, indicating their significant participation in higher academic ranks associated with professional recognition, academic expertise, and institutional leadership.

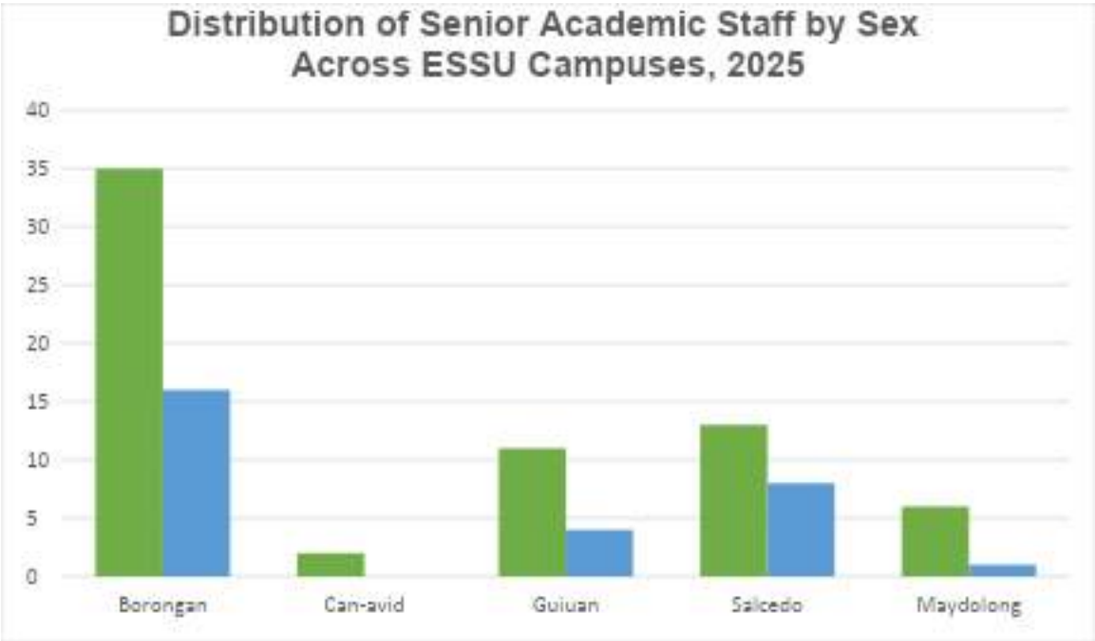
The representation of women across the five campuses further demonstrates that their participation in senior academic positions is not concentrated in a single institutional location. Rather, female academics hold senior academic ranks across the university's geographically distributed campuses, contributing to a more inclusive academic environment and strengthening

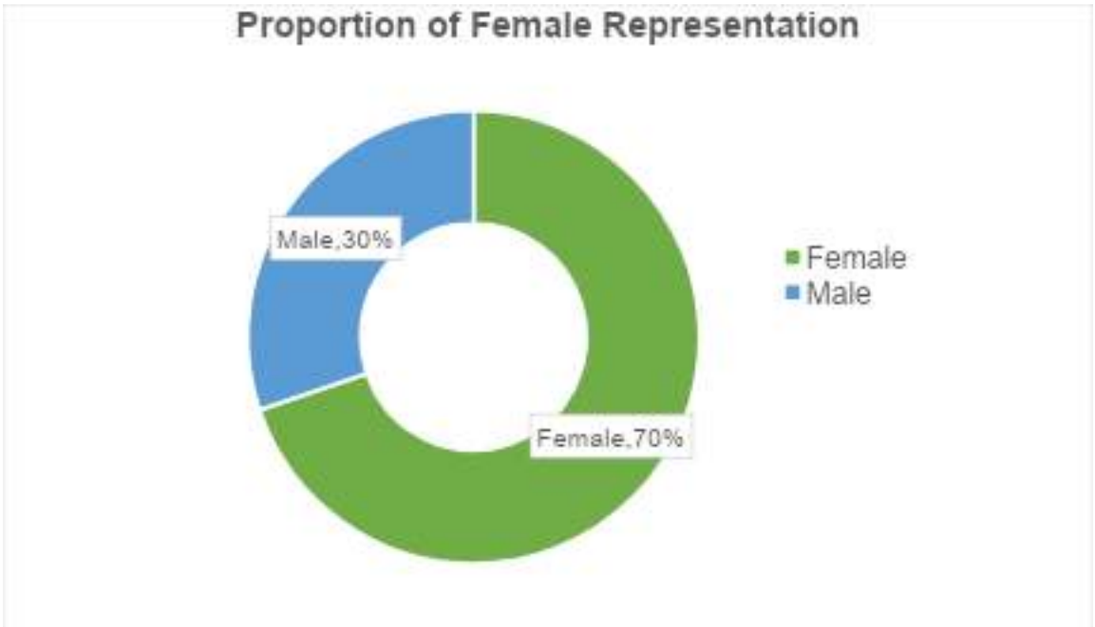
the university's capacity for academic leadership, mentorship, research, instruction, and institutional development.

Distribution of Senior Academic Staff by Sex and Campus

The distribution of senior academic personnel across ESSU's five campuses provides a more detailed understanding of women's representation in higher academic ranks.

Campus	Female	Male	Total	Proportion of Female Representation	Percentage of Female Representation
Borongan	35	16	51	0.6863	68.63%
Can-avid	2	0	2	1.0000	100.00%
Guiuan	11	4	15	0.7333	73.33%
Salcedo	13	8	21	0.6190	61.90%
Maydolong	6	1	7	0.8571	85.71%
Total	**67**	**29**	**96**	**0.6979**	**69.79%**





The campus-level distribution reveals that women constitute the majority of identified senior academic personnel in all five campuses.

Borongan Campus has the largest number of senior female academics, with 35 women out of 51 senior academic personnel. This corresponds to a female proportion of 0.6863 (68.63%), reflecting the substantial presence of women in higher academic ranks within the university's main campus.

Can-avid Campus records two senior academic personnel, both of whom are women, resulting in a female proportion of 1.0000 (100.00%). Although this is the highest proportion among the campuses, the relatively small number of personnel should be considered in interpreting the result.

Guiuan Campus has 11 female academics among 15 senior academic personnel, equivalent to a female proportion of 0.7333 (73.33%). This indicates that women hold a substantial majority of the identified senior academic positions in the campus.

Salcedo Campus records 13 female academics out of 21 senior academic personnel, representing a female proportion of 0.6190 (61.90%). Although this is the lowest female representation among the five campuses, women still constitute the majority of its identified senior academic workforce.

Maydolong Campus has six female academics among seven senior academic personnel, equivalent to a female proportion of 0.8571 (85.71%). This demonstrates a particularly strong representation of women in the campus's higher academic ranks.

Taken together, these results demonstrate that female academics occupy the majority of identified senior academic positions across all five ESSU campuses. This institutional distribution is significant because it illustrates women's participation in higher academic ranks across different campus settings and organizational contexts.

Interpretation and Institutional Impact

The results provide important insights into ESSU's contribution to SDG 5: Gender Equality, particularly in relation to women's representation in senior academic positions.

1. Advancing Women's Representation in Senior Academic Positions

   The female proportion of 0.6979 (69.79%) demonstrates that women have a strong presence in the university's senior academic workforce. Their representation in Professor and Associate Professor positions reflects opportunities for professional advancement and recognition of academic qualifications and expertise.

   The substantial participation of women in these higher academic ranks demonstrates that they are an important part of the university's academic leadership and professional community. It also reinforces the importance of maintaining institutional practices that support equitable opportunities for women to advance in their academic careers.

2. Promoting Inclusive Academic Leadership Across Campuses

   The presence of female academics in senior positions across Borongan, Can-avid, Guiuan, Salcedo, and Maydolong demonstrates the geographical distribution of women's participation in higher academic ranks.

   The campus-level proportions, ranging from 0.6190 (61.90%) in Salcedo to 1.0000 (100.00%) in Can-avid, indicate that women constitute the majority of identified senior academic personnel in each campus.

   This distribution contributes to a more inclusive institutional environment by strengthening women's opportunities to serve as academic mentors, role models, researchers, and contributors to institutional development. Their participation across campuses also supports the development of an academic community that recognizes the contributions and leadership capacities of women.

3. Supporting Equal Opportunities and Institutional Development

   The representation of women in senior academic positions supports the principle that academic advancement should be accessible regardless of sex.

   Women's participation strengthens the university's pool of academic expertise and leadership capacity. Their contributions to instruction, research, extension, curriculum development, and institutional initiatives enrich the university's academic environment and support its broader development objectives.

   Furthermore, the visibility of women in higher academic ranks provides opportunities for mentoring and professional inspiration among junior female faculty members. This can contribute to a supportive institutional culture that encourages women's continued professional growth and advancement.

4. Contributing to UN Sustainable Development Goal Target 5.5

   The findings are particularly relevant to UN Target 5.5, which calls for ensuring women's full and effective participation and equal opportunities for leadership at all levels of decision-making in political, economic, and public life.

   By demonstrating substantial female representation in senior academic ranks, ESSU provides institutional evidence of its contribution to gender equality within higher education.

The presence of women in senior academic positions is an important dimension of inclusive academic development. It reflects women's participation in the university's professional structure and provides a foundation for strengthening their involvement in academic leadership, institutional governance, and decision-making.

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SUSTAINABLE DEVELOPMENT GOALS

5.5 PROPORTION OF WOMEN RECEIVING DEGREES

5.5.1 INDICATOR: PROPORTION OF FEMALE DEGREES AWARDED



5 GENDER EQUALITY

5.5 PROPORTION OF WOMEN RECEIVING DEGREES

5.5.1 INDICATOR: PROPORTION OF FEMALE DEGREES AWARDED

Eastern Samar State University (ESSU) demonstrates its commitment to gender equality in higher education through the participation and successful completion of academic programs by women. In support of **UN Sustainable Development Goal 5: Gender Equality,** particularly **Target 5.1**, which seeks to end all forms of discrimination against women and girls everywhere, the University monitors the number and proportion of female graduates across its academic programs.

For Academic Year 2024 – 2025, ESSU recorded a total of **4,561 graduates at all levels,** of whom **2,709 were women**, representing **59.39% of the total graduates.** This indicates that women accounted for more than half of the University's graduating population, demonstrating their substantial participation and achievement in higher education.

The indicator, Proportion of female degrees awarded, is defined as the **number of women who are awarded a degree, divided by the total number of students who are awarded a degree.** The data are provided as headcounts. The data is subject-weighted against three broad areas: STEM; medicine; and arts, humanities and social sciences.

The distribution of graduates across these subject areas provides a more comprehensive understanding of women's academic achievements and representation in different fields of study.

I. Distribution of Graduates by Subject Area

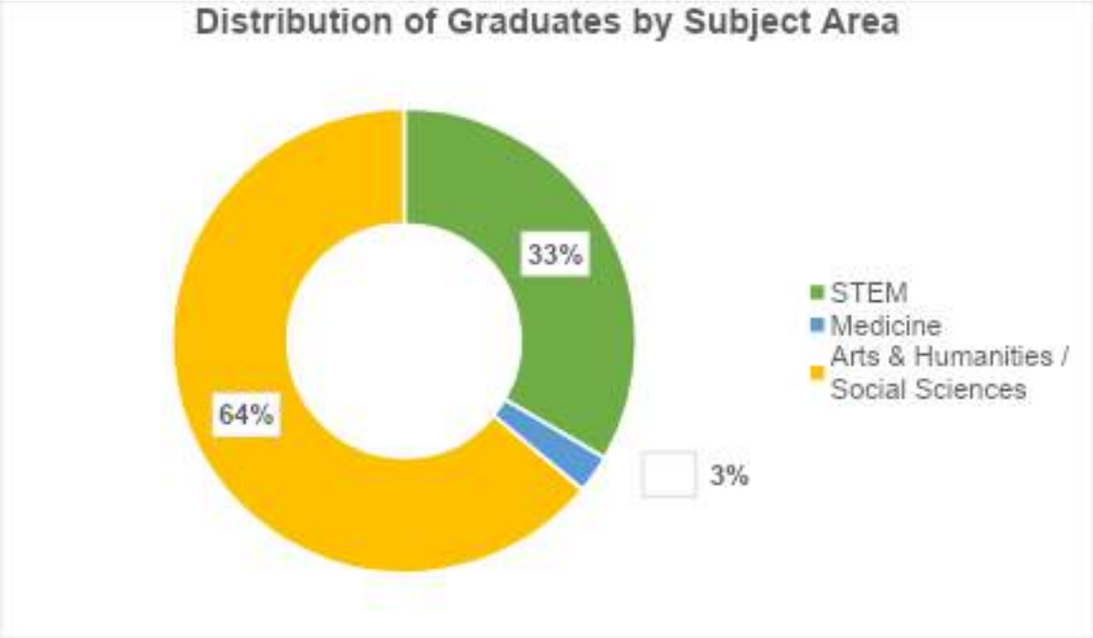
Of the 4,561 graduates, 1,524 completed programs under Science, Technology, Engineering, and Mathematics (STEM), 122 graduated from Medicine-related programs, and 2,915 completed programs under Arts and Humanities/Social Sciences.

The Arts and Humanities/Social Sciences category accounted for the largest proportion of graduates, representing approximately 63.91% of the total. STEM accounted for 33.41%, while Medicine represented 2.67%.

Distribution of Graduates by Broad Subject Area, AY 2024 – 2025

Broad Subject Area	Total Graduates	Percentage
STEM	1,524	33.41%
Medicine	122	2.67%
Arts & Humanities / Social Sciences	2,915	63.91%
Total	**4,561**	**100%**

Distribution of Graduates by Subject Area



The distribution shows that ESSU produces graduates across diverse academic disciplines, with a particularly substantial contribution from Arts and Humanities/Social Sciences. The presence of graduates in STEM and Medicine also reflects the University's contribution to developing human resources in technical, scientific, and health-related fields.

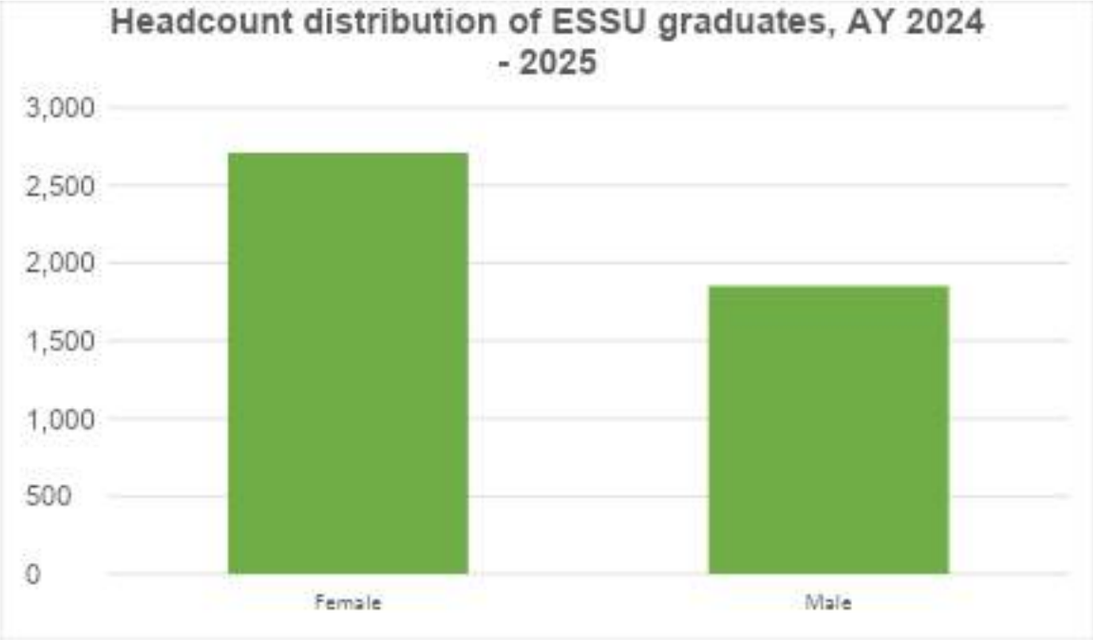
II. Number and Proportion of Female Graduates

Of the 4,561 graduates in 2025, 2,709 were women, equivalent to **59.39%,** while the remaining 1,852 graduates, or 40.61%, were men.

Number and Proportion of Female Graduates, AY 2024 – 2025

Gender	Number of Graduates	Percentage
Female	2,709	59.39%
Male	1,852	40.61%
Total	**4,561**	**100%**

Graduates by Gender



The data reveal that female graduates exceeded male graduates by 857, demonstrating that women constituted the majority of ESSU's graduating population. This is an important indication of women's substantial representation among degree recipients and their participation in the University's academic programs.

Female Graduates by Broad Subject Area

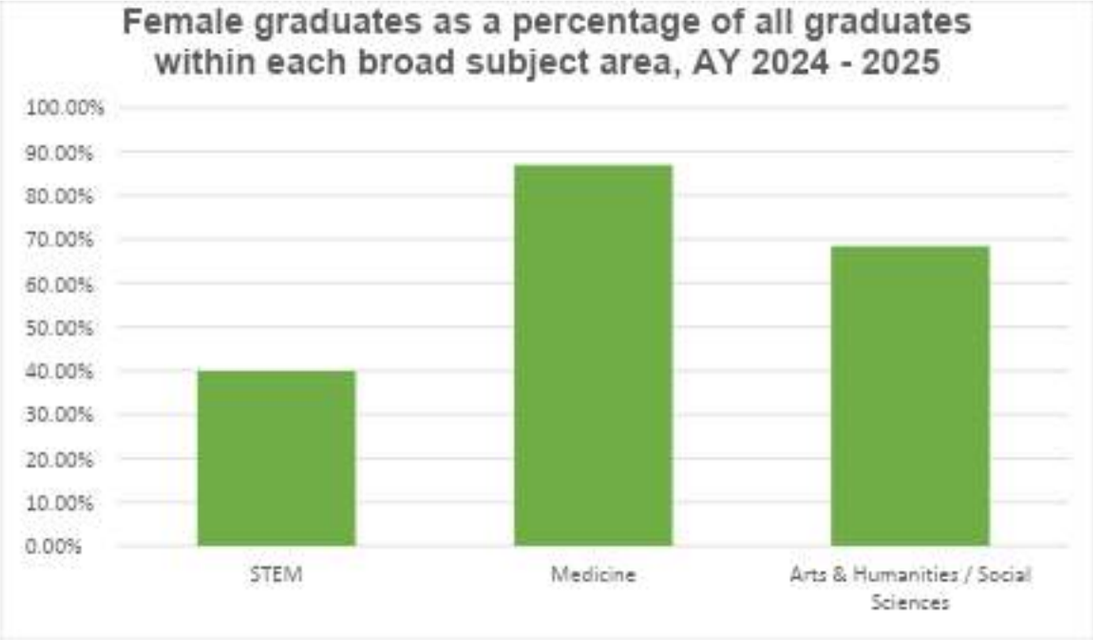
A closer examination of female graduates across the three broad subject areas shows that women are represented in all academic disciplines, although their proportions vary.

In Arts and Humanities/Social Sciences, **1,994 of the 2,915 graduates** were women, accounting for 68.44% of graduates in this subject area. In Medicine, women accounted for 106 of the 122 graduates, equivalent to 86.89%. Meanwhile, STEM recorded 609 female graduates out of 1,524, representing 39.96%.

Distribution of Female Graduates by Broad Subject Area, AY 2024 - 2025

Broad Subject Area	Total Graduates	Female Graduates	Female Graduates (%)
STEM	1,524	609	39.96%
Medicine	122	106	86.89%
Arts & Humanities / Social Sciences	2,915	1,994	68.44%
Total	**4,561**	**2,709**	**59.39%**

Proportion of Female Graduates by Subject Area



The results reveal several important observations about women's academic achievements at ESSU:

- **Medicine**: Women represented 86.89% of graduates, indicating particularly strong female representation in health-related academic programs. This demonstrates women's substantial participation in preparing for professions that contribute to healthcare delivery and community well-being.
- **Arts & Humanities / Social Sciences**: Women constituted 68.44% of graduates, making this the largest subject area in terms of both total and female graduates. The 1,994 female graduates demonstrate women's significant contribution to disciplines that develop competencies in education, public service, social development, governance, and other related fields.
- **STEM**: Women accounted for 39.96% of STEM graduates. Although this is the only subject area in which female graduates did not constitute the majority, the 609 women who completed STEM programs represent an important contribution to women's participation in science, technology, engineering, and mathematics.

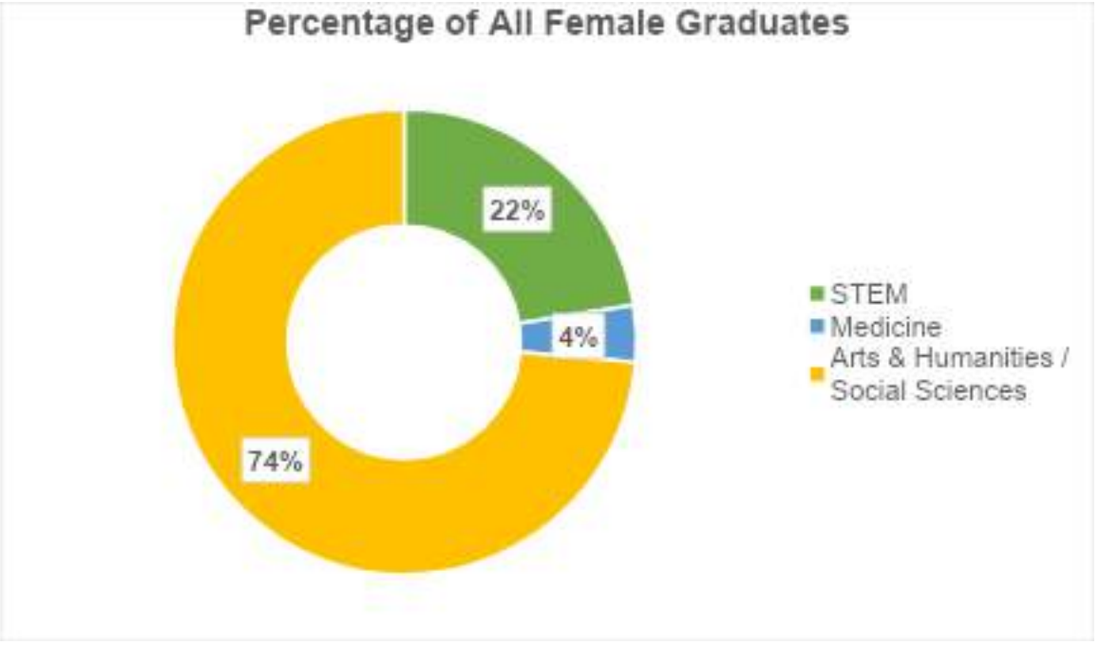
These findings demonstrate that women's academic achievements extend across different disciplines. While female representation is particularly high in Medicine and Arts and Humanities/Social Sciences, the STEM figures also provide an important institutional reference point for strengthening women's access, participation, and achievement in traditionally male-dominated fields.

IV. Distribution of Female Graduates Across Subject Areas

Looking at the composition of the 2,709 female graduates, 1,994 (73.60%) completed programs in Arts and Humanities/Social Sciences, 609 (22.48%) graduated from STEM programs, and 106 (3.91%) completed Medicine-related programs.

Distribution of Female Graduates Across Broad Subject Areas, AY 2024 - 2025

Broad Subject Area	Female Graduates	Percentage of All Female Graduates
STEM	609	22.48%
Medicine	106	3.91%
Arts & Humanities / Social Sciences	1,994	73.60%
Total	**2,709**	**100%**



This distribution highlights the concentration of female graduates in Arts and Humanities/Social Sciences while also demonstrating women's participation in STEM and Medicine. It provides ESSU with an evidence-based reference for evaluating the distribution of women's academic achievements and identifying areas where additional opportunities and support mechanisms may be strengthened.

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SUSTAINABLE DEVELOPMENT GOALS

5.6 WOMEN'S PROGRESS MEASURES

5.6.1 Policy of Non-discrimination Against Women



5 GENDER EQUALITY

5.6 WOMEN'S PROGRESS MEASURES

5.6.1 Policy of Non-discrimination Against Women

Eastern Samar State University (ESSU) strictly maintains an institutional governance framework establishing that all campuses have a policy of non-discrimination against women. Operationalized system-wide, this formal Policy of non-discrimination against women guarantees full respect for human rights, equal opportunities, and human dignity for all workers, employees, applicants, students, student-trainees, and members of the university community across all academic and administrative operations.

Institutional compliance is grounded on two board-approved and administratively sanctioned policy instruments: (1) the Board of Regents (BOR)-approved Procedural Rules of the Committee on Decorum and Investigation (CODI) for Sexual Harassment and Other Gender-Based Sexual Harassment (ESSU CODI Manual,), which governs sexual harassment and gender-based misconduct system-wide; and (2) the Salcedo Campus Anti-Discrimination Policy and Guidelines on Reporting Procedures and Protection Measures (Office Order 2024-006, issued August 15, 2024), which serves as an operational blueprint for gender fairness across university campuses.

Universal Scope of Protection & Protected Grounds

ESSU's anti-discrimination policy applies universally across all administrative offices, academic colleges, departments, and physical/virtual premises. Covered individuals include university personnel (whether permanent, temporary, or contractual), faculty, administrators, students, student-interns, applicants for employment or admission, third-party service providers (such as security personnel), personnel of contracted partner institutions, and campus visitors.

The framework explicitly prohibits unfair, unequal, or biased treatment across eight explicitly defined grounds: sex or gender, sexual orientation, gender identity and expression (SOGIE), age, race or ethnicity, religion or belief, disability, and socioeconomic status. Furthermore, university regulations prohibit any acts by officials or employees that limit, segregate, or classify female employees or students in ways that diminish their academic, professional, or advancement opportunities.

Governing Frameworks & Prohibited Misconduct

To ensure a safe environment free from prejudice and violence, ESSU penalizes both quid pro quo misconduct and hostile environment creation pursuant to Republic Act 7877 (Anti-Sexual Harassment Act), Republic Act 11313 (Safe Spaces Act), Civil Service rules, and CHED regulations. Prohibited misconduct encompasses:

Street-Level and Public-Space Gender-Based Sexual Harassment (GBSH): Catcalling, wolf-whistling, misogynistic, transphobic, or homophobic slurs, persistent uninvited comments on appearance, unwanted sexual invitations, public masturbation, groping, stalking, and unwanted physical advances.

Digital / Online GBSH: Cyber-stalking, incessant messaging with sexual overtones, unauthorized uploading or sharing of private media with sexual content, online sexist slurs, and filing false abuse reports to silence victims.

Mandatory Female Leadership & Inclusive Governance Structure

ESSU enforces statutory gender representation rules to ensure impartial, gender-responsive governance. Both the Investigating Committee and the ESSU CODI must be chaired by a woman, and not less than 50% of their total membership must be women.

Governance bodies feature multi-sectoral composition: the Investigating Committee includes the Guidance Councilor, Head of Social Work, Union President, SSC Vice President, and Legal

Office Representative. The ESSU CODI comprises representatives from the Administration, Teaching Staff, Non-Teaching Staff, Supreme Student Council President, and explicitly mandates representation from a member of the LGBTQ+A community.

Grievance Mechanisms, Protective Safeguards & Sanctions

Reporting channels include the ESSU Public Assistance Desk, GAD Office (Old Library Bldg), VAWC desks, and official email (gadoffice.essusalcedo@essu.edu.ph). Complaints are routed to CODI within 24 hours, acknowledged in writing within 3 working days, and undergo preliminary investigation within 10 calendar days. Strict confidentiality is maintained throughout, and retaliation against complainants or witnesses is classified as a major infraction leading to termination or dismissal.

Interim protective measures include preventive suspensions (up to 30 days for personnel; up to 20% of class days per term for students), No Contact Orders, Cease and Desist Orders, schedule adjustments, and Gender Hub counseling referrals. Administrative sanctions follow CSC and Safe Spaces Act rules, categorized into Light (reprimand to 30-day suspension), Less Grave (1-6 month suspension to dismissal/expulsion), and Grave offenses (dismissal from service, student expulsion, or permanent campus bans for visitors and third-party vendors)..

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Policy Dimension	Focus Provision & Legal / Administrative Basis	Scope & Specific Enforcement Mechanisms	Institutional Policy Document
1. Policy Mandate & Commitment	Board-approved policy establishing that all ESSU campuses have a policy of non-discrimination against women.	Enforces non-discrimination against women, guaranteeing respect for human rights and dignity across all academic, work, and campus environments.	ESSU CODI Manual (BOR Approved) & GAD Office Order 2024-006
2. Covered Scope & Stakeholders	Universal system-wide application across all campuses, offices, colleges, and university premises.	Covers faculty, non-teaching staff (regular/contractual), administrators, students, interns, job/admission applicants, third-party security, partner staff, and visitors.	ESSU CODI Rules (Rule II) & Salcedo Guidelines (Section III)
3. Protected Grounds	Explicit prohibition of unfair, unequal, or discriminatory treatment and classification.	Prohibits discrimination based on 8 grounds: Sex/Gender, SOGIE, Age, Race/Ethnicity, Religion/Belief, Disability, and Socioeconomic Status. Forbids classifying women to diminish advancement.	Salcedo Anti-Discrimination Policy (Section IV) & CODI Rules (Rule III)
4. Prohibited Misconduct & Harassment	Comprehensive coverage of Quid Pro Quo, Hostile Environment, Street-Level GBSH, and Online GBSH.	Penalizes catcalling, wolf-whistling, sexist/transphobic/homophobic slurs, stalking, groping, cyber-stalking, unauthorized media sharing, and harassment under R.A. 7877 & R.A. 11313.	ESSU CODI Manual (Rule III, Section 1.b)
5. Female Leadership & Diversity	Mandatory female headship and 50% female representation in investigative committees.	Investigating Committee and CODI must be chaired by a woman and be ≥50% female. Multisectoral representation includes SSC leaders, Legal, Guidance, Social Work, and LGBTQ+A members.	ESSU CODI Rules (Rule IV, Section 1.a & 1.b)
6. Reporting & Investigation SLAs	Multi-channel reporting structures with strict administrative processing timelines.	Filing via Public Assistance Desk, GAD Office, VAWC desk, or email. Routing within 24 hours; acknowledgment within 3 days; preliminary investigation completed in 10 calendar days.	CODI Rules (Rule IV, Sec 3–5) & Salcedo Guidelines (Sec III)

7. Protection Safeguards & Anti-Retaliation	Strict confidentiality standards, non-retaliation enforcement, and victim assistance.	Retaliation is a major infraction punishable by dismissal/termination. Offers counseling referrals, Gender Hub services, and strict privacy protections during and after proceedings.	CODI Rules (Rule IV, Sec 16) & Salcedo Guidelines (Sec IV)
8. Preventive Suspensions & Orders	Time-bound administrative protective measures during pending investigations.	Personnel preventive suspension up to 30 days; student preventive suspension up to 20% of class days per term. Includes No Contact Orders, Cease & Desist Orders, and campus access restrictions.	ESSU CODI Rules (Rule V, Section 1.a)
9. Sanctions & Penalties Scale	Graded disciplinary penalties aligned with Civil Service rules and R.A. 11313 (Safe Spaces Act).	Light Offenses: Reprimand to 30-day suspension. Less Grave: 1–6 months suspension to dismissal/expulsion. Grave / Visitors: Dismissal, student expulsion, or permanent campus bans.	ESSU CODI Manual (Rule V, Offenses & Sanctions Table)

Policy of Strengthening Non-discrimination Against Women



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OFFICE OF THE BOARD OF REGENTS

EXCERPT FROM THE MINUTES OF THE 2ND QUARTER BOARD MEETING OF THE ESSU BOARD OF REGENTS FOR CY 2024 HELD ON SEPTEMBER 13, 2024 AT HIGHER EDUCATION DEVELOPMENT CENTER (HEDC) BUILDING, DILIMAN QUEZON CITY.

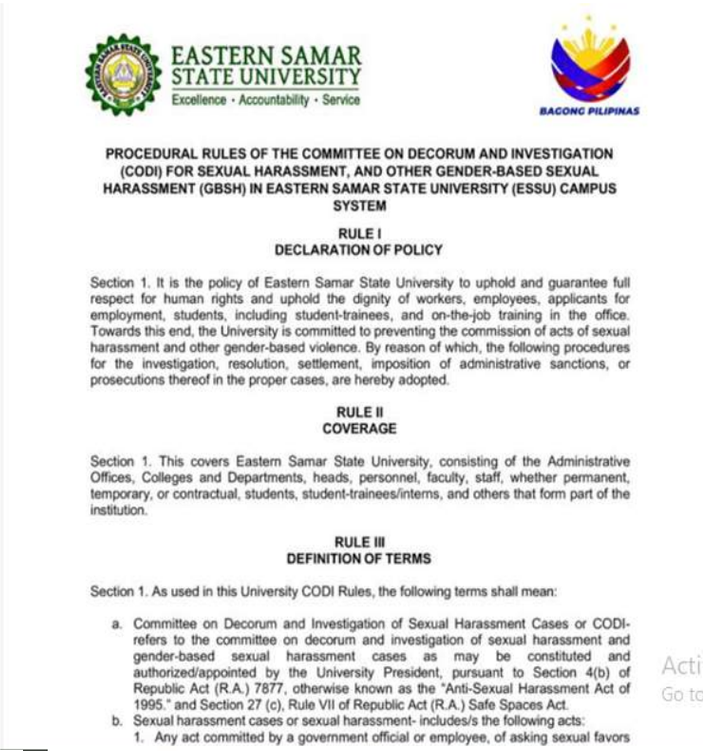
RESOLUTION NO. 179
Series of 2024

A RESOLUTION APPROVING THE PROCEDURAL RULES OF COMMITTEE ON DECORUM AND INVESTIGATION (CODI) FOR SEXUAL HARASSMENT CASES IN EASTERN SAMAR STATE UNIVERSITY (ESSU) CAMPUSES.

CERTIFIED CORRECT

DEBBIE JOY S. R. VOLOSO, DM
Board Secretary

RELEASED



EASTERN SAMAR STATE UNIVERSITY
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BAGONG PILIPINAS

PROCEDURAL RULES OF THE COMMITTEE ON DECORUM AND INVESTIGATION (CODI) FOR SEXUAL HARASSMENT, AND OTHER GENDER-BASED SEXUAL HARASSMENT (GBSH) IN EASTERN SAMAR STATE UNIVERSITY (ESSU) CAMPUS SYSTEM

RULE I
DECLARATION OF POLICY

Section 1. It is the policy of Eastern Samar State University to uphold and guarantee full respect for human rights and uphold the dignity of workers, employees, applicants for employment, students, including student-trainees, and on-the-job training in the office. Towards this end, the University is committed to preventing the commission of acts of sexual harassment and other gender-based violence. By reason of which, the following procedures for the investigation, resolution, settlement, imposition of administrative sanctions, or prosecutions thereof in the proper cases, are hereby adopted.

RULE II
COVERAGE

Section 1. This covers Eastern Samar State University, consisting of the Administrative Offices, Colleges and Departments, heads, personnel, faculty, staff, whether permanent, temporary, or contractual, students, student-trainees/interns, and others that form part of the institution.

RULE III
DEFINITION OF TERMS

Section 1. As used in this University CODI Rules, the following terms shall mean:

a. Committee on Decorum and Investigation of Sexual Harassment Cases or CODI- refers to the committee on decorum and investigation of sexual harassment and gender-based sexual harassment cases as may be constituted and authorized/appointed by the University President, pursuant to Section 4(b) of Republic Act (R.A.) 7877, otherwise known as the "Anti-Sexual Harassment Act of 1995." and Section 27 (c), Rule VII of Republic Act (R.A.) Safe Spaces Act.
b. Sexual harassment cases or sexual harassment- includes/s the following acts:
   1. Any act committed by a government official or employee, of asking sexual favors

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EASTERN SAMAR STATE UNIVERSITY
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Anti-Discrimination Policy

Gender and Development (GAD) Office
ESSU-Salcedo

I. Policy Statement

Eastern Samar State University- Salcedo Campus, through its Gender and Development (GAD) Office, is committed to promoting equality, inclusivity, and respect for all members of the academic community. Discrimination in any form has no place in the university and will not be tolerated. Every student, faculty, staff, and visitor has the right to a learning and working environment free from prejudice and bias.

II. Purpose

This policy aims to:

1. Prevent all forms of discrimination within the university.
2. Promote gender equality, diversity, and respect for human rights.
3. Provide guidelines for addressing and resolving discrimination-related concerns.

III. Scope

This policy applies to all members of the university community, including:

- Students



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OFFICE ORDER
2024-006

TO: All Faculty Members, Non-Teaching Personnel, and Students

FROM: GENDER AND DEVELOPMENT OFFICE

DATE: AUGUST 15, 2024

SUBJECT IMPLEMENTATION OF GUIDELINES ON REPORTING PROCEDURES AND PROTECTION MEASURES AGAINST DISCRIMINATION

1. Purpose

The Gender and Development (GAD) Office of Eastern Samar State University – Salcedo Campus is committed to maintaining a safe, inclusive, and equitable learning environment for all. In line with this commitment, the GAD Office issues the Guidelines on Reporting Procedures and Protection Measures Against Discrimination to ensure that all members of the university community are informed about how to report discriminatory acts and how they will be protected throughout the process

2. Scope

This policy applies to all members of the ESSU–Salcedo community, including:

- Students
- Faculty and staff
- Administrators
- Contractual personnel
- Visitors and stakeholders within university premise

Supporting Documents Link:

Non-discrimination Policy - Borongan Campus
https://drive.google.com/file/d/19dQWFC3aD1ZJmUjOQmX_FGYSWzd4qKB2/view?usp=drive_link

Non-discrimination Policy - Salcedo Campus
https://drive.google.com/file/d/1dv9rhtd9vm5s5QBnxzRN0TgdhkUi7HoL/view?usp=drive_link

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SUSTAINABLE DEVELOPMENT GOALS

5.6 WOMEN'S PROGRESS MEASURES

5.6.2 Non-discrimination policies for transgender



5 GENDER EQUALITY

5.6.2 Non-discrimination policies for transgender

Eastern Samar State University (ESSU) strictly enforces comprehensive Non-discrimination policies for transgender individuals across its entire institutional system. Established and actively implemented system-wide by 2024 (SDG-5 Indicator 5.6.2 Document, p. 1), board-approved governance frameworks establish that all ESSU campuses have a policy of non-discrimination for transgender people. This mandate guarantees equal rights, human dignity, and explicit protection from prejudice or bias for transgender individuals and the broader LGBTQ+A community across all learning, research, and working environments (ESSU Salcedo Anti-Discrimination Policy, Sec. I & VII).

Institutional governance is anchored on two primary policy instruments:

1. ESSU CODI Manual (Procedural Rules of the Committee on Decorum and Investigation for Sexual Harassment and Other Gender-Based Sexual Harassment): Formally approved by the ESSU Board of Regents (BOR) for system-wide implementation across all campuses (Rule I, Sec. 1 & Rule II, Sec. 1) pursuant to Republic Act (R.A.) 7877, R.A. 11313 (Safe Spaces Act), CHED regulations, and Civil Service rules.

2. Salcedo Campus Anti-Discrimination Policy & Reporting Guidelines (Office Order 2024-006): Issued on August 15, 2024, by the Gender and Development (GAD) Office and approved by campus administration, serving as an operational benchmark for system-wide adoption (Office Order 2024-006, Sec. 1–4).

The universal scope covers all administrative offices, academic departments, colleges, and university premises (CODI Manual, Rule II, Sec. 1; Salcedo Guidelines, Sec. II). Covered persons include faculty, regular, temporary, or contractual employees, administrators, students, student-trainees/interns, job/admission applicants, third-party service providers (such as security personnel), partner institution personnel, and visitors (CODI Manual, Rule III, Sec. 1.c; Salcedo Guidelines, Sec. III). The policy explicitly prohibits unfair or unequal treatment across eight protected grounds: sex or gender, sexual orientation, gender identity and expression (SOGIE), age, race or ethnicity, religion or belief, disability, and socioeconomic status (ESSU Salcedo Anti-Discrimination Policy, Sec. IV).

Prohibited misconduct explicitly targets transphobic behavior and gender-identity discrimination. The CODI Manual explicitly penalizes transphobic slurs under Street-Level and Public-Space GBSH (Rule III, Sec. 1.b.3), online transphobic remarks and comments (Rule III, Sec. 1.b.2), and derogatory or degrading remarks directed toward a person's sexual orientation or gender identity (Rule V, Penalty Table for Less Grave Offenses, Item a). Furthermore, the policy penalizes unwelcome inquiries or comments about a person's sex life or sexual orientation (e.g., LGBTQ+ sexual relations) as a punishable administrative offense (Rule V, Penalty Table for Light Offenses, Item a).

To ensure direct inclusion in institutional governance, the ESSU CODI Manual mandates that committee membership explicitly includes a designated Representative and member of the LGBTQ+A community (Rule IV, Sec. 1.b.4). Additionally, both the CODI and the Investigating Committee must be chaired by a woman, and not less than 50% of their total membership must be women (Rule IV, Sec. 1.a & 1.b).

Grievances can be filed via the Public Assistance Desk, GAD Office (Old Library Bldg), VAWC desks, or email (gadoffice.essusalcedo@essu.edu.ph). Complaints are routed to CODI within 24 hours, acknowledged within 3 working days, and preliminary investigations conclude within 10 calendar days (CODI Manual, Rule IV, Sec. 3–5; Salcedo Guidelines, Sec. III). Retaliation against transgender complainants or witnesses is classified as a major infraction

subject to termination or dismissal (CODI Manual, Rule IV, Sec. 16; Salcedo Guidelines, Sec. IV.2). Protective measures include preventive suspensions (up to 30 days for personnel or 20% of class days per term for students), No Contact Orders, schedule adjustments, and Gender Hub counseling services (CODI Manual, Rule V, Sec. 1; Salcedo Guidelines, Sec. IV.3–4). Penalties range from reprimands and suspensions to dismissal from service, student expulsion, or permanent campus bans for third-party entities and visitors (CODI Manual, Rule V, Penalty Tables).

Matrix of Salient Policy Provisions

Policy Dimension	Focus Provision & SOGIE Basis	Scope & Enforcement Mechanisms	Source & Page Citation
1. Policy Mandate & Commitment	Institutional Non-discrimination policies for transgender establishing that all ESSU campuses have a policy of non-discrimination for transgender people.	Established and actively implemented system-wide by 2024 via BOR-approved CODI Manual and Office Order 2024-006. Guarantees equal rights and protection for transgender individuals.	*SDG-5 Indicator 5.6.2 Doc (p. 1); ESSU CODI Manual (Rule I, Sec. 1); Office Order 2024-006 (Sec. 1)*
2. Protected Grounds & SOGIE	Explicit protection covering Gender Identity and Expression (SOGIE).	Prohibits discrimination, bias, or unequal treatment across 8 grounds: Sex/Gender, Sexual Orientation, Gender Identity & Expression (SOGIE), Age, Race/Ethnicity, Religion/Belief, Disability, and Socioeconomic Status.	*Salcedo Anti-Discrimination Policy (Sec. IV); ESSU CODI Manual (Rule III, Sec. 1.b)*
3. Universal Scope of Protection	System-wide application across all physical and virtual university premises.	Applies universally to faculty, regular/contractual non-teaching staff, administrators, students, interns, job/admission applicants, third-party security, partner staff, and visitors.	*ESSU CODI Manual (Rule II, Sec. 1 & Rule III, Sec. 1.c); Salcedo Guidelines (Sec. II & III)*
4. Transphobic Harassment Prohibited	Categorical prohibition of transphobic slurs, remarks, and gender-identity misconduct.	Explicitly penalizes transphobic slurs, derogatory comments on gender identity/expression, unwelcome inquiries into sex life or orientation (e.g., LGBTQ+ relations), street-level GBSH, and digital/online harassment.	*ESSU CODI Manual (Rule III, Sec. 1.b.2-3 & Rule V Penalty Tables: Less Grave Item a, Light Item a)*
5. LGBTQ+A Governance Role	Statutory inclusion of transgender/LGBTQ+A representation in governance bodies.	Mandates that ESSU CODI membership explicitly includes a designated Representative and member of the LGBTQ+A community. Investigating bodies must be chaired by a woman with ≥50% female composition.	*ESSU CODI Manual (Rule IV, Sec. 1.a & Sec. 1.b.4)*
6. Reporting & Administrative SLAs	Multi-channel reporting mechanisms with standardized processing SLA timelines.	Filing via Public Assistance Desk, GAD Office (Old Library Bldg), VAWC desks, or email (gadoffice.essusalcedo@essu.edu.ph). 24-hr routing; 3-day written acknowledgment; 10-day preliminary investigation.	*ESSU CODI Manual (Rule IV, Sec. 3.a & Sec. 5.c); Salcedo Guidelines (Sec. III.1–4)*
7. Protection & Anti-Retaliation	Strict confidentiality guarantees, anti-retaliation	Enforces strict confidentiality. Retaliation against transgender complainants or	*ESSU CODI Manual (Rule IV, Sec. 16 & Rule V, Sec.*

Policy Dimension	Focus Provision & SOGIE Basis	Scope & Enforcement Mechanisms	Source & Page Citation
	rules, and victim support services.	witnesses is a major infraction leading to termination/dismissal. Provides Gender Hub counseling and workplace/academic adjustments.	*1); Salcedo Guidelines (Sec. IV.1–3)*
8. Interim Protective Orders	Time-bound administrative protection orders during ongoing investigations.	Personnel preventive suspension up to 30 days; student preventive suspension up to 20% of term class days. Enforces No Contact Orders, Cease & Desist Orders, and campus facility access bans.	*ESSU CODI Manual (Rule V, Sec. 1.a–d); Salcedo Guidelines (Sec. IV.4)*
9. Disciplinary Penalties Scale	Graded penalty structure under Civil Service Commission rules and R.A. 11313 (Safe Spaces Act).	Light Offenses: Reprimand to 30-day suspension. Less Grave Offenses: 1–6 months suspension to dismissal/expulsion. Grave Offenses / Visitors: Dismissal from service, student expulsion, or permanent campus ban.	*ESSU CODI Manual (Rule V, Penalty Tables for Light, Less Grave, & Grave Offenses)*

Supporting Document Link:

Non-discrimination Policy - Borongan Campus
https://drive.google.com/file/d/19dQWFC3aD1ZJmUjOQmX_FGYSWzd4qKB2/view?usp=drive_link

Non-discrimination Policy - Salcedo Campus
https://drive.google.com/file/d/1dv9rhtd9vm5s5QBnxzRN0TgdhkUi7HoL/view?usp=drive_link

Non-discrimination Policy Documentation


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OFFICE OF THE BOARD OF REGENTS

EXCERPT FROM THE MINUTES OF THE 1ST QUARTER BOARD MEETING OF THE ESSU BOARD OF REGENTS FOR CY 2024 HELD ON SEPTEMBER 13, 2024 AT HIGHER EDUCATION DEVELOPMENT CENTER (HEDC) BUILDING, DILIMAN QUEZON CITY.

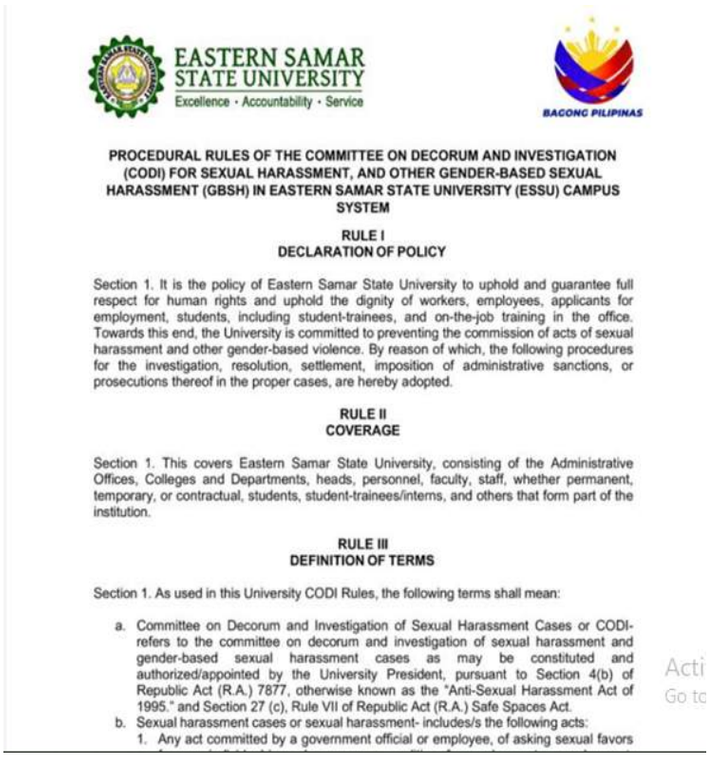
RESOLUTION NO. 179
Series of 2024

A RESOLUTION APPROVING THE PROCEDURAL RULES OF COMMITTEE ON DECORUM AND INVESTIGATION (CODI) FOR SEXUAL HARASSMENT CASES IN EASTERN SAMAR STATE UNIVERSITY (ESSU) CAMPUSES.

CERTIFIED CORRECT:

DEBBIE JOYCE R. YOLONG, DM
Board Secretary

RELEASED


EASTERN SAMAR STATE UNIVERSITY
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BAGONG PILIPINAS

PROCEDURAL RULES OF THE COMMITTEE ON DECORUM AND INVESTIGATION (CODI) FOR SEXUAL HARASSMENT, AND OTHER GENDER-BASED SEXUAL HARASSMENT (GBSH) IN EASTERN SAMAR STATE UNIVERSITY (ESSU) CAMPUS SYSTEM

RULE I
DECLARATION OF POLICY

Section 1. It is the policy of Eastern Samar State University to uphold and guarantee full respect for human rights and uphold the dignity of workers, employees, applicants for employment, students, including student-trainees, and on-the-job training in the office. Towards this end, the University is committed to preventing the commission of acts of sexual harassment and other gender-based violence. By reason of which, the following procedures for the investigation, resolution, settlement, imposition of administrative sanctions, or prosecutions thereof in the proper cases, are hereby adopted.

RULE II
COVERAGE

Section 1. This covers Eastern Samar State University, consisting of the Administrative Offices, Colleges and Departments, heads, personnel, faculty, staff, whether permanent, temporary, or contractual, students, student-trainees/interns, and others that form part of the institution.

RULE III
DEFINITION OF TERMS

Section 1. As used in this University CODI Rules, the following terms shall mean:

a. Committee on Decorum and Investigation of Sexual Harassment Cases or CODI- refers to the committee on decorum and investigation of sexual harassment and gender-based sexual harassment cases as may be constituted and authorized/appointed by the University President, pursuant to Section 4(b) of Republic Act (R.A.) 7877, otherwise known as the "Anti-Sexual Harassment Act of 1995." and Section 27 (c), Rule VII of Republic Act (R.A.) Safe Spaces Act.
b. Sexual harassment cases or sexual harassment- includes/s the following acts:
   1. Any act committed by a government official or employee, of asking sexual favors

Acti
Go to

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Anti-Discrimination Policy

Gender and Development (GAD) Office
ESSU-Salcedo

I. Policy Statement

Eastern Samar State University- Salcedo Campus, through its Gender and Development (GAD) Office, is committed to promoting equality, inclusivity, and respect for all members of the academic community. Discrimination in any form has no place in the university and will not be tolerated. Every student, faculty, staff, and visitor has the right to a learning and working environment free from prejudice and bias.

II. Purpose

This policy aims to:

1. Prevent all forms of discrimination within the university.
2. Promote gender equality, diversity, and respect for human rights.
3. Provide guidelines for addressing and resolving discrimination-related concerns.

III. Scope

This policy applies to all members of the university community, including:

- Students

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OFFICE ORDER
2024-006

TO: All Faculty Members, Non-Teaching Personnel, and Students

FROM: GENDER AND DEVELOPMENT OFFICE

DATE: AUGUST 15, 2024

SUBJECT IMPLEMENTATION OF GUIDELINES ON REPORTING PROCEDURES AND PROTECTION MEASURES AGAINST DISCRIMINATION

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1. Purpose

The Gender and Development (GAD) Office of Eastern Samar State University – Salcedo Campus is committed to maintaining a safe, inclusive, and equitable learning environment for all. In line with this commitment, the GAD Office issues the Guidelines on Reporting Procedures and Protection Measures Against Discrimination to ensure that all members of the university community are informed about how to report discriminatory acts and how they will be protected throughout the process

2. Scope

This policy applies to all members of the ESSU–Salcedo community, including:

- Students
- Faculty and staff
- Administrators
- Contractual personnel
- Visitors and stakeholders within university premise

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SUSTAINABLE DEVELOPMENT GOALS

5.6 WOMEN'S PROGRESS MEASURES

5.6.3 MATERNITY POLICY



5 GENDER EQUALITY

5.6.3 MATERNITY POLICY

Eastern Samar State University (ESSU) demonstrates its commitment to supporting women's participation in the workplace through institutional maternity leave provisions and the implementation of legally mandated maternity protection measures. The University's maternity policy framework recognizes maternity as a protected employment entitlement and establishes mechanisms that enable female employees to exercise their right to maternity leave while maintaining their employment security and professional standing.

The institutional basis for this commitment is documented in the **Human Resource Management Office Operations Manual, Version 1 (2022)**, particularly Section 10.9, **Maternity Leave**. The manual provides for maternity leave for both married and unmarried women in every instance of pregnancy, irrespective of its frequency. It also establishes administrative procedures for filing maternity leave applications and specifies the applicable leave and compensation arrangements in accordance with the employee's length of service and governing regulations.

This institutional provision is reinforced by **Republic Act No. 11210**, otherwise known as the **105-Day Expanded Maternity Leave Law**, and its Implementing Rules and Regulations. As a public higher education institution, ESSU recognizes the statutory maternity entitlements applicable to female employees in government service, including:

- **105 days of maternity leave with full pay** for live childbirth, regardless of the mode of delivery;
- **An additional 15 days of paid maternity leave** for qualified solo parents;
- **60 days of maternity leave with full pay** in cases of miscarriage or emergency termination of pregnancy;
- **An optional additional 30 days of maternity leave without pay** following live childbirth; and
- The option to use earned sick leave credits for an extended leave period with pay, subject to applicable civil service regulations.

These provisions provide meaningful institutional support for women by allowing female employees to address their maternal and family responsibilities without having to relinquish their employment or professional commitments. The availability of paid maternity leave is particularly significant because it provides income protection during pregnancy, childbirth, and recovery, thereby helping reduce the potential economic and professional disadvantages associated with motherhood.

ESSU's maternity protection framework also reinforces **employment security and non-discrimination**. Under the Implementing Rules and Regulations of Republic Act No. 11210, the exercise of maternity leave rights cannot be used as a basis for demotion or termination of employment. Employers are likewise prohibited from discriminating against women to avoid providing the maternity benefits guaranteed under the law. These safeguards protect women's professional standing and reinforce their right to participate in employment without being disadvantaged by pregnancy or the exercise of maternity-related entitlements.

Furthermore, maternity protection recognizes the particular employment arrangements of women in the teaching profession. Female teachers may avail themselves of maternity leave even during long vacations, including summer and Christmas vacations, with corresponding maternity leave benefits and proportional vacation pay (PVP), subject to applicable rules. This provision is especially relevant to ESSU as a higher education institution because it recognizes the academic calendar and safeguards the maternity entitlements of female teaching personnel despite the distinctive scheduling arrangements of the teaching profession.

Taken together, the institutional provisions in the Human Resource Management Office Operations Manual and the statutory protections under Republic Act No. 11210 establish a framework that supports women's continued participation in university employment. The policy recognizes that maternity should not become a barrier to career continuity, professional development, or economic security. By providing paid leave, employment protection, and maternity-related safeguards, ESSU promotes a more inclusive and gender-responsive working environment in which women can fulfill their maternal responsibilities while retaining their professional opportunities.

In relation to the THE Sustainability Impact Ratings 2027, the Human Resource Management Office Operations Manual, Version 1, was created in 2022, placing it within the methodology's specified 2022–2026 period. The university also provides documentary evidence of its maternity policy, with the evidence identified as publicly accessible. These institutional documentation and accessibility provisions demonstrate alignment with the four assessment components of Indicator 5.6.3: existence of policy, evidence provided, public availability of evidence, and policy creation or review within the specified period.

Through these measures, ESSU demonstrates that supporting women's participation involves more than providing employment opportunities; it also requires protecting women during significant life events that may affect their professional responsibilities. The university's maternity policy framework therefore contributes to gender equality by strengthening employment security, promoting work-life balance, and ensuring that motherhood does not become a source of disadvantage in women's participation in the academic and administrative workforce.

ESSU Policy on Maternity Leave

in any or various government agencies for the last twelve months prior to undergoing surgery.

10.8.3 This leave may be availed for every instance of gynecological disorder requiring surgery for a maximum period of two months per year.

10.8.4 Availment of the said leave benefits shall be in accordance with the list of surgical operations for gynecological disorder. Those not found in the list of procedures may be allowed subject to certification of a medical authority.

10.8.5 The following requirements are to be submitted to the HRMO:

10.8.5.1 Accomplished application for leave, however, in instances when an employee undergoes emergency surgical procedure, the said leave application shall be filed immediately upon employees return to work.

10.8.5.2 Medical certificate reflecting the gynecological disorder, histopathgological report, operative technique and the duration of the surgery.

10.9 Maternity Leave

10.9.1 A leave of absence granted to married or unmarried woman in every instance of pregnancy irrespective of its frequency.

10.9.2 Employees who have rendered less than two years of service may only receive full pay for a number of days based on the ratio of sixty days to two years of service.

10.9.3 An application for leave is filed together with the employee's clearance.

10.10 Sabbatical Leave

Sabbatical leaveis one of the components of the faculty development programs of the University which is a means of enhancing professional learning activities. It is also a mechanism whereby faculty members are accorded the opportunity to rest and take time to engage in worthwhile educational endeavors. It also provides a reward system to deserving faculty members who have rendered long period of service to the University with exemplary performance and achievements.

10.10.1 Qualifications and Requirements

10.10.1.1 Must be a regular faculty member with permanent item or tenure.

10.10.1.2 Must have served the University or any of its campuses for a minimum of twenty years.

10.10.1.3 Must hold an academic rank of at least Assistant Professor

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Link to Other Evidence:

[Republic Act No. 11210 – 105-Day Expanded Maternity Leave Law]

[Implementing Rules and Regulations of RA 11210]

[Civil Service Commission Memorandum Circular No. 5, s. 2021]

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SUSTAINABLE DEVELOPMENT GOALS

5.6 WOMEN'S PROGRESS MEASURES

5.6.4 CHILDCARE FACILITIES FOR STUDENTS



5 GENDER EQUALITY

5.6 WOMEN'S PROGRESS MEASURES

5.6.4 CHILDCARE FACILITIES FOR STUDENTS

Eastern Samar State University (ESSU) demonstrates its commitment to promoting inclusive access to higher education and supporting **student-mothers** through the provision of accessible**, free-of-charge childcare-related facilities** that enable mothers, particularly those with young children, to continue their university education and attend academic activities. Consistent with the Times Higher Education Sustainability Impact Ratings criterion, **Have accessible childcare facilities for students which allow recent mothers to attend university courses**," the University has institutionalized support mechanisms that address the childcare and breastfeeding needs of students, helping them balance their maternal responsibilities with their academic pursuits.

A significant institutional initiative supporting this commitment is the **ESSU-Salcedo Policy and Guidelines on the Use of the GAD Lactation and Limited Play Area**, established through the Gender and Development (GAD) Office. The policy provides students, including nursing mothers and student-parents, with access to a designated lactation area and limited play area for young children. Importantly, the facilities are provided **free of charge**, removing potential financial barriers and ensuring that student-mothers can access these support services without additional expenses.

The lactation area provides a private, hygienic, safe, and comfortable environment where nursing students can breastfeed their children or express breast milk while attending to their academic responsibilities. It is equipped with a comfortable chair, air conditioning, and an electrical outlet to facilitate breastfeeding and milk expression. The facility is accessible during regular office hours, from 8:00 AM to 5:00 PM, Monday to Friday. This provision is particularly important for recent mothers who need appropriate spaces and opportunities to continue breastfeeding while pursuing their university education.

Complementing the lactation facility, the limited play area provides a designated space where young children, particularly those aged two to seven years, can stay temporarily while their student-parents attend to academic requirements and other university-related activities. The area accommodates simple, quiet, and safe activities such as reading, coloring, and playing with soft toys. Its availability provides an additional support mechanism for student-mothers who may need to bring their children to campus, helping them manage childcare responsibilities while maintaining their participation in university courses and academic activities.

The policy explicitly identifies female students and nursing mothers, alongside faculty and staff, as intended beneficiaries of the facilities. It also recognizes student-parents who occasionally bring their young children to campus. By formally including students among the eligible users, ESSU-Salcedo demonstrates that its childcare-related support is not exclusively intended for university employees but also addresses the needs of students, particularly mothers who face challenges in reconciling childcare responsibilities with their educational aspirations.

At the university level, **Board of Regents (BOR) Resolution No. 167, Series of 2024**, further demonstrates ESSU's institutional commitment to strengthening gender-responsive facilities. The resolution approved the construction of **Phase I of the Gender Hub at the ESSU Main Campus**, with an allocated budget of **PHP 5,000,000.00**, for implementation in 2025. This initiative represents a strategic investment in institutional infrastructure intended to strengthen gender and development services and provide a more supportive environment for members of the university community, including student-mothers. It complements the existing childcare-related support initiative at ESSU-Salcedo and reflects the University's broader commitment to expanding gender-responsive facilities across its campuses.

The impact of these initiatives extends beyond the physical provision of facilities. By offering free access to lactation and limited childcare-related play spaces, ESSU helps address practical barriers that may prevent recent mothers from regularly attending classes, participating in academic activities, and continuing their education. The lactation area supports the maternal and breastfeeding needs of nursing students, while the limited play area provides temporary accommodation for their young children. Together, these services contribute to a more inclusive and accommodating learning environment where motherhood and childcare responsibilities are recognized and considered in institutional support planning.

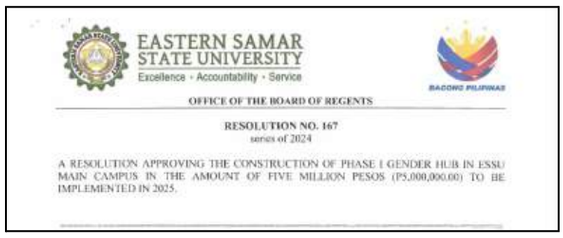
To ensure the responsible and sustainable utilization of the facilities, the policy establishes operational guidelines covering user registration, first-come, first-served access, cleanliness and safety requirements, parental supervision, and a maximum usage period of one hour per session. The GAD Office is responsible for maintaining the cleanliness and order of the facility, keeping usage records, and providing basic supplies, while the Campus Administrator oversees implementation and ensures institutional support. Quarterly monitoring reports and the collection of user feedback also provide mechanisms for evaluating facility utilization and identifying opportunities for improvement.

In relation to the Times Higher Education Sustainability Impact Ratings, these initiatives provide evidence that ESSU has **accessible childcare facilities for students which allow recent mothers to attend university courses**. The free-of-charge provision of the GAD Lactation and Limited Play Area directly addresses the accessibility component of the indicator by ensuring that eligible student-mothers can utilize the facilities without paying user fees. The institutional policy establishes the intended beneficiaries, access arrangements, and operational procedures, while BOR Resolution No. 167, s. 2024, demonstrates the University's continuing

investment in gender-responsive infrastructure. The public availability of these institutional documents further supports transparency and verifiability.

Overall, ESSU's provision of free and accessible lactation and limited play facilities demonstrates an institutional commitment to reducing childcare-related barriers to higher education. By supporting student-mothers in fulfilling both their maternal and academic responsibilities, the University promotes a more inclusive educational environment, strengthens opportunities for women to pursue and complete their studies, and advances gender equality through practical institutional support.

BOR Resolution No. 167 S.2024



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OFFICE OF THE BOARD OF REGENTS

RESOLUTION NO. 167
series of 2024

A RESOLUTION APPROVING THE CONSTRUCTION OF PHASE I GENDER HUB IN ESSU MAIN CAMPUS IN THE AMOUNT OF FIVE MILLION PESOS (P5,000,000.00) TO BE IMPLEMENTED IN 2025.

Policy and Guidelines on the Use of the GAD Lactation and Limited Play Area

EASTERN SAMAR STATE UNIVERSITY
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POLICY AND GUIDELINES ON THE USE OF THE GAD LACTATION AND LIMITED PLAY AREA

Gender and Development (GAD) Office
ESSU-Salcedo

I. Policy Statement

The Eastern Samar State University – Salcedo Campus (ESSU–Salcedo), through its Gender and Development (GAD) Office, is committed to promoting gender equality and supporting women's welfare by providing a Lactation and Limited Play Area within the GAD Office.

This facility serves as a safe and comfortable space for nursing mothers to breastfeed or express milk, and for student-parents or staff to briefly accommodate their children during study or work-related activities.

II. Objectives

1. To support and promote exclusive breastfeeding among nursing mothers in the university.
2. To provide a private and hygienic space for lactating students, faculty, and staff.
3. To offer a limited play area where children of student-parents or employees can safely stay for a short period under supervision.
4. To create a family-friendly environment that recognizes the needs of mothers and caregivers in the academic community.

III. Scope

This policy applies to:

- Female students, faculty, and staff who are nursing mothers;
- Student-parents or employees who occasionally bring their young children to campus;
- GAD personnel assigned to monitor and maintain the area.

IV. Facilities and Services

1. **Lactation Area**
   - Located inside the GAD Office, equipped with a comfortable chair, air condition, electrical outlet and Lactation room.
   - Accessible during office hours (8:00 AM – 5:00 PM, Monday to Friday).
   - Designed for privacy, cleanliness, and safety.
2. **Limited Play Area**
   - A small, designated space within the GAD Office for young children (ages 2–7) of student-parents or staff.
   - Provides simple, quiet, and safe activities such as reading, coloring, or playing with soft toys.
   - Available only while the parent is present or within the GAD Office premises.

V. Guidelines for Use

1. **Registration and Access**
   - Users must sign in the Logbook at the GAD Office.
   - Use is on a first-come, first-served basis to maintain comfort and privacy.
2. **Cleanliness and Safety**
   - Users must clean the area after use and properly dispose of waste materials.
   - Children must always be accompanied and supervised by their parent or guardian.
   - Toys or play materials must be returned to their proper place after use.
3. **Time Limit**
   - Lactation and play area use is limited to a maximum of 1 hour per session to accommodate all users fairly.
4. **Prohibited Activities**
   - Bringing food (except milk or snacks for children), sharp objects, or electronic devices not related to childcare.
   - Leaving a child unattended under any circumstances.

VI. Responsibilities

Office/Individual	Responsibilities
GAD Office	Maintain the cleanliness and order of the lactation/play area, keep records of use, and provide basic supplies.
Users (Mothers/Parents)	Ensure proper use of facilities, maintain cleanliness, and supervise their children at all times.
Campus Administrator	Oversee implementation and ensure continued support for GAD facilities and programs.

VII. Monitoring and Evaluation

- The GAD Office shall monitor the facility's usage and submit quarterly reports to the Campus Administrator.
- Feedback from users will be collected to improve services and maintain safety standards.

VIII. Effectivity

This policy shall take effect immediately upon approval and shall form part of ESSU–Salcedo's Gender and Development (GAD) initiatives supporting women's health and family-friendly practices.

EASTERN SAMAR STATE UNIVERSITY
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SUSTAINABLE DEVELOPMENT GOALS

5.6 WOMEN'S PROGRESS MEASURES

5.6.5 CHILDCARE FACILITIES FOR STAFF AND FACULTY



5 GENDER EQUALITY

5.6 WOMEN'S PROGRESS MEASURES

5.6.5 CHILDCARE FACILITIES FOR STAFF AND FACULTY

Eastern Samar State University (ESSU) demonstrates its commitment to promoting gender equality, supporting **working mothers**, and fostering a family-friendly institutional environment through initiatives that provide childcare-related facilities and support services for its faculty and staff. Consistent with the Times Higher Education Sustainability Impact Ratings criterion, **"Have childcare facilities for staff and faculty,"** the University has undertaken institutional measures to establish and provide accessible, **free-of-charge facilities** that respond to the childcare, breastfeeding, and family-related needs of its academic community.

One significant institutional initiative is the **Board of Regents (BOR) Resolution No. 167, Series of 2024**, which approved the construction of **Phase I of the Gender Hub at the ESSU Main Campus**, with an allocated budget of **PHP 5,000,000.00**, for implementation in 2025. This resolution represents the University's formal commitment to institutionalizing gender-responsive facilities and strengthening its support infrastructure for women and other members of the university community. The proposed Gender Hub is an important investment in creating an environment that recognizes the needs of women, particularly working mothers, and supports their participation in academic and professional responsibilities.

Complementing this university-level initiative, **ESSU-Salcedo has established the Policy and Guidelines on the Use of the GAD Lactation and Limited Play Area** through its Gender and Development (GAD) Office. This initiative provides a concrete institutional mechanism for addressing the childcare and breastfeeding needs of students, faculty, and staff. The facility is provided **free of charge**, ensuring that eligible members of the university community can access its services without financial barriers. It consists of a designated lactation area and a limited play area for young children, particularly those aged two to seven years, whose parents are studying or working on campus.

The lactation area provides a private, hygienic, safe, and comfortable space for nursing mothers to breastfeed or express milk. It is equipped with a comfortable chair, air conditioning, and an electrical outlet, and is accessible during regular office hours, from 8:00 AM to 5:00 PM, Monday to Friday. Meanwhile, the limited play area provides a designated space where children of student-parents or employees can safely stay for a short period under parental supervision. The area accommodates simple, quiet, and safe activities, including reading, coloring, and playing with soft toys. By providing these services free of charge, ESSU-Salcedo demonstrates its commitment to making essential maternal and childcare support accessible regardless of the financial circumstances of its beneficiaries.

The policy explicitly recognizes female students, faculty, and staff who are nursing mothers, as well as student-parents and employees who occasionally bring their young children to campus. By extending the use of these facilities to both academic personnel and students, ESSU-Salcedo demonstrates an inclusive approach to family-friendly campus services. The

initiative helps address practical challenges encountered by working mothers and parents, particularly the need to attend to childcare responsibilities while fulfilling their academic and professional obligations.

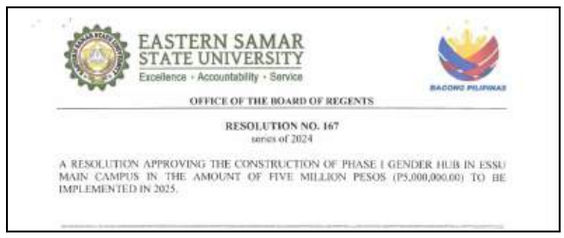
The institutional significance of this initiative extends beyond the provision of physical facilities. It contributes to a more supportive and accommodating working environment by recognizing that childcare and breastfeeding responsibilities should not become barriers to women's continued participation, productivity, and professional development. Providing a dedicated lactation space supports breastfeeding mothers in maintaining their breastfeeding practices while attending to their university-related responsibilities. Similarly, the free limited play area offers parents an additional measure of support when childcare arrangements are necessary during study or work-related activities.

The policy also establishes operational safeguards to ensure the responsible and sustainable use of the facilities. These include user registration, first-come, first-served access, cleanliness and safety requirements, parental supervision, and a maximum usage period of one hour per session. The GAD Office is responsible for maintaining the cleanliness and order of the facility, keeping usage records, and providing basic supplies, while the Campus Administrator oversees implementation and ensures continued institutional support. Furthermore, the requirement for quarterly monitoring reports and the collection of user feedback provide mechanisms for evaluating facility utilization and improving service delivery.

Taken together, the BOR-approved Gender Hub project and the operational GAD Lactation and Limited Play Area policy demonstrate ESSU's institutional efforts to provide childcare facilities for staff and faculty. These initiatives reflect the University's recognition of the importance of gender-responsive infrastructure, maternal support, and family-friendly institutional practices in advancing women's welfare and participation in higher education. In particular, the provision of the lactation and limited play area **free of charge** demonstrates that the University's support is not merely infrastructural but also accessible and responsive to the practical needs of its academic community.

For the Times Higher Education Sustainability Impact Ratings, these documented initiatives provide evidence of the University's efforts to establish childcare-related facilities and support mechanisms for its academic personnel. The availability of the facility without user fees strengthens the University's demonstration of free access to childcare-related support. The public availability of the supporting BOR resolution and institutional policy further demonstrates transparency and institutional accountability. Through these measures, ESSU advances an enabling environment in which women, particularly mothers, can better balance their professional, academic, and family responsibilities while remaining active and productive members of the university community.

BOR Resolution No. 167 S.2024



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BAGONG PILIPINAS

OFFICE OF THE BOARD OF REGENTS

RESOLUTION NO. 167
series of 2024

A RESOLUTION APPROVING THE CONSTRUCTION OF PHASE I GENDER HUB IN ESSU MAIN CAMPUS IN THE AMOUNT OF FIVE MILLION PESOS (P5,000,000.00) TO BE IMPLEMENTED IN 2025.

~~Policy and Guidelines on the Use of the GAD Lactation and Limited Play~~ Area

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POLICY AND GUIDELINES ON THE USE OF THE GAD LACTATION AND LIMITED PLAY AREA

Gender and Development (GAD) Office
ESSU-Salcedo

I. Policy Statement

The Eastern Samar State University – Salcedo Campus (ESSU–Salcedo), through its Gender and Development (GAD) Office, is committed to promoting gender equality and supporting women's welfare by providing a Lactation and Limited Play Area within the GAD Office.

This facility serves as a safe and comfortable space for nursing mothers to breastfeed or express milk, and for student-parents or staff to briefly accommodate their children during study or work-related activities.

II. Objectives

1. To support and promote exclusive breastfeeding among nursing mothers in the university.
2. To provide a private and hygienic space for lactating students, faculty, and staff.
3. To offer a limited play area where children of student-parents or employees can safely stay for a short period under supervision.
4. To create a family-friendly environment that recognizes the needs of mothers and caregivers in the academic community.

III. Scope

This policy applies to:

- Female students, faculty, and staff who are nursing mothers;
- Student-parents or employees who occasionally bring their young children to campus;
- GAD personnel assigned to monitor and maintain the area.

IV. Facilities and Services

1. **Lactation Area**
   - Located inside the GAD Office, equipped with a comfortable chair, air condition, electrical outlet and Lactation room.
   - Accessible during office hours (8:00 AM – 5:00 PM, Monday to Friday).
   - Designed for privacy, cleanliness, and safety.
2. **Limited Play Area**
   - A small, designated space within the GAD Office for young children (ages 2–7) of student-parents or staff.
   - Provides simple, quiet, and safe activities such as reading, coloring, or playing with soft toys.
   - Available only while the parent is present or within the GAD Office premises.

V. Guidelines for Use

1. **Registration and Access**
   - Users must sign in the Logbook at the GAD Office.
   - Use is on a first-come, first-served basis to maintain comfort and privacy.
2. **Cleanliness and Safety**
   - Users must clean the area after use and properly dispose of waste materials.
   - Children must always be accompanied and supervised by their parent or guardian.
   - Toys or play materials must be returned to their proper place after use.
3. **Time Limit**
   - Lactation and play area use is limited to a maximum of 1 hour per session to accommodate all users fairly.
4. **Prohibited Activities**
   - Bringing food (except milk or snacks for children), sharp objects, or electronic devices not related to childcare.
   - Leaving a child unattended under any circumstances.

VI. Responsibilities

Office/Individual	Responsibilities
GAD Office	Maintain the cleanliness and order of the lactation/play area, keep records of use, and provide basic supplies.
Users (Mothers/Parents)	Ensure proper use of facilities, maintain cleanliness, and supervise their children at all times.
Campus Administrator	Oversee implementation and ensure continued support for GAD facilities and programs.

VII. Monitoring and Evaluation

- The GAD Office shall monitor the facility's usage and submit quarterly reports to the Campus Administrator.
- Feedback from users will be collected to improve services and maintain safety standards.

VIII. Effectivity

This policy shall take effect immediately upon approval and shall form part of ESSU–Salcedo's Gender and Development (GAD) initiatives supporting women's health and family-friendly practices.

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SUSTAINABLE DEVELOPMENT GOALS

5.6 WOMEN'S PROGRESS MEASURES

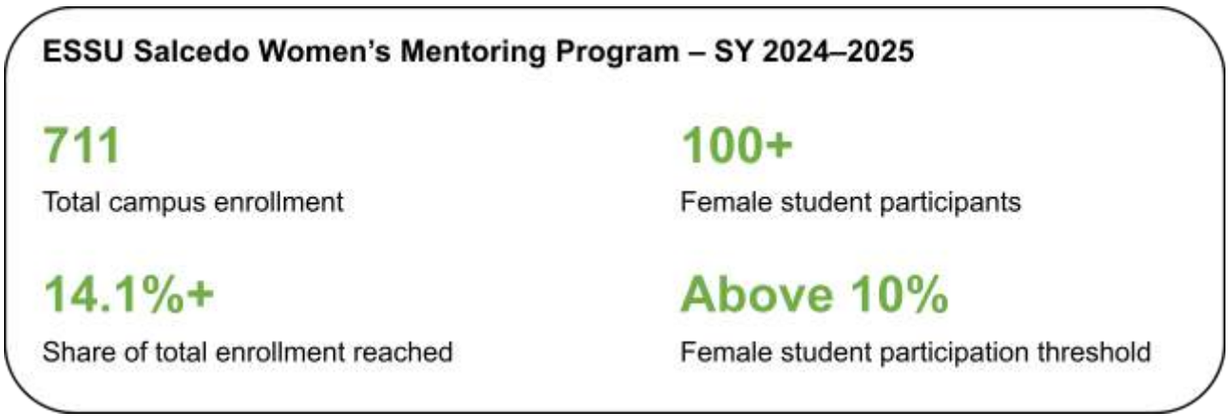
5.6.6 WOMEN'S MENTORING SCHEMES



5 GENDER EQUALITY

5.6 WOMEN'S PROGRESS MEASURES

5.6.6 WOMEN'S MENTORING SCHEMES



Eastern Samar State University (ESSU), through the Gender and Development (GAD) Office of the ESSU-Salcedo Campus, implements a structured Women's Mentoring **Program** to empower female students by providing opportunities for personal development, leadership enhancement, academic guidance, and professional growth. The initiative reflects the University's commitment to advancing gender equality by establishing a supportive environment where women can develop their capabilities, build confidence, exchange experiences, and strengthen their participation in academic and community activities.

The program is guided by established **Guidelines on Women's Mentoring Program**, which provide the institutional framework for its objectives, implementation procedures, mentoring approaches, and monitoring mechanisms. It aims to facilitate meaningful mentoring relationships between experienced women professionals, faculty members, and female students, enabling the transfer of knowledge, skills, experiences, and practical guidance. Through these relationships, the program supports women's personal and professional development while fostering a culture of mentorship, collaboration, and mutual empowerment within the University.

To accommodate varying mentoring needs and maximize participation, the program employs four mentoring approaches: **one-on-one mentoring, group mentoring, workshops and seminars, and peer mentoring**. These approaches provide opportunities for individualized guidance as well as collective learning and support. Group mentoring and peer mentoring, in particular, enable multiple female students to benefit from shared experiences, collaborative discussions, and guidance from mentors. This arrangement expands the program's reach and strengthens its capacity to generate significant impact beyond mentoring relationships involving only one or two students.

The program follows a systematic implementation process encompassing participant registration, mentor-mentee matching, mentoring agreements, regular mentoring sessions, monitoring and evaluation, and recognition of outstanding mentors and mentees. Participants register through the GAD Office or designated coordinator, while mentors and mentees are matched according to their development goals, fields of interest, and compatibility. Mentoring

pairs are expected to meet at least once a month for coaching, discussions, and goal tracking. The GAD Office also monitors the progress of mentoring engagements through feedback forms, reflection journals, and periodic reports. These mechanisms provide an organized approach to sustaining mentoring relationships and assessing their contributions to participants' development.

The program demonstrates substantial student participation and institutional reach. During the First Semester of School Year 2024–2025, ESSU-Salcedo recorded a total enrollment of **711 students**, of whom **more than 100 female students participated in the Women's Mentoring Program**. This means that female participants alone accounted for more than **14.1% of the campus's total student enrollment**. Since the methodology specifically considers participation among female students, the proportion of female students reached by the program is consequently higher than this conservative enrollment-based figure, subject to the corresponding female student population. Thus, the program exceeds the minimum participation threshold of at least 10% of female students prescribed under THE Indicator 5.6.6.

This level of participation demonstrates that the initiative is not merely a small-scale mentoring activity intended for a limited number of beneficiaries. Rather, it represents an institutional mentoring scheme with the capacity to engage a substantial number of female students. The participation of more than 100 women demonstrates the program's broad reach and its potential to create meaningful and sustained benefits across the campus community. The use of group mentoring, peer mentoring, and other structured mentoring activities further strengthens its capacity to accommodate multiple participants and extend the benefits of mentoring to a wider population of women.

The program's implementation is further demonstrated through documented group mentoring sessions under the GAD Program at ESSU-Salcedo. Photographic documentation shows female students actively participating in mentoring activities facilitated by women mentors. These engagements provide opportunities for participants to share their experiences, discuss challenges, seek guidance, and learn from the experiences of others. The activities foster an environment of trust, encouragement, and mutual support, allowing female students to recognize their potential, strengthen their self-confidence, and develop competencies relevant to their academic and future professional endeavors.

Beyond the immediate benefits to individual participants, the Women's Mentoring Program contributes to broader institutional and social outcomes. It supports the development of women's leadership potential, encourages their active participation in academic and organizational activities, strengthens professional and peer networks, and promotes awareness of gender equality and women's rights. By connecting experienced women with younger members of the academic community, the program also facilitates the intergenerational sharing of knowledge and experiences, helping cultivate future women leaders and professionals.

In relation to the Times Higher Education Sustainability Impact Ratings 2027, Indicator 5.6.6, ESSU-Salcedo demonstrates the existence of a structured women's

mentoring scheme, evidence of its actual implementation, and participation exceeding the prescribed minimum threshold. The formal program guidelines establish the existence of the scheme; the documented mentoring activities demonstrate its implementation; and the participation of more than 100 female students out of 711 total enrolled students establishes its substantial institutional reach. These elements directly address the methodology's expectation that women's mentoring schemes should have significant impact and not just for one or two students, and that such schemes should have capacity for many women.

Through the sustained implementation of this initiative, Eastern Samar State University reinforces its commitment to gender-responsive education and women's empowerment. The Women's Mentoring Program serves as an institutional mechanism for developing women's capabilities, expanding opportunities for personal and professional advancement, and fostering an inclusive academic environment in which women are supported, encouraged, and empowered to contribute meaningfully to university and community development.

Link to Evidence:

Mentoring Guidelines - Salcedo Campus

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SUSTAINABLE DEVELOPMENT GOALS

5.6 WOMEN'S PROGRESS MEASURES

5.6.7 Track Women's Graduation Rate



5 GENDER EQUALITY

5.6 WOMEN'S PROGRESS MEASURES

5.6.7 Track Women's Graduation Rate

Eastern Samar State University (ESSU) recognizes the importance of monitoring women's academic progress and ensuring equitable opportunities for both women and men to complete their higher education. As part of its commitment to gender equality and inclusive education, the University maintains sex-disaggregated student records across its five campuses to support the measurement and tracking of women's likelihood of graduating compared to men's.

For the First Semester of School Year 2024–2025, ESSU recorded a consolidated student population of **4,561, consisting of 2,709 female students (59.39%) and 1,852 male students (40.61%).** The figures indicate that women constitute the majority of the University's student population, accounting for approximately six out of every ten enrolled students. This demonstrates substantial female participation in higher education across the University's campuses.

The campus-level distribution further illustrates women's participation in higher education. Salcedo Campus recorded the highest proportion of female students at 63.81%, followed by Can-avid Campus at 60.36%, Borongan Campus at 59.41%, Guiuan Campus at 58.47%, and Maydolong Campus at 53.82%.

These figures provide the University with an important baseline for examining gender representation in its academic programs and strengthening institutional mechanisms for monitoring student progression and completion. By maintaining sex-disaggregated enrollment records, ESSU can identify patterns in women's participation, establish comparisons between male and female students, and use the resulting information to inform gender-responsive student support initiatives.

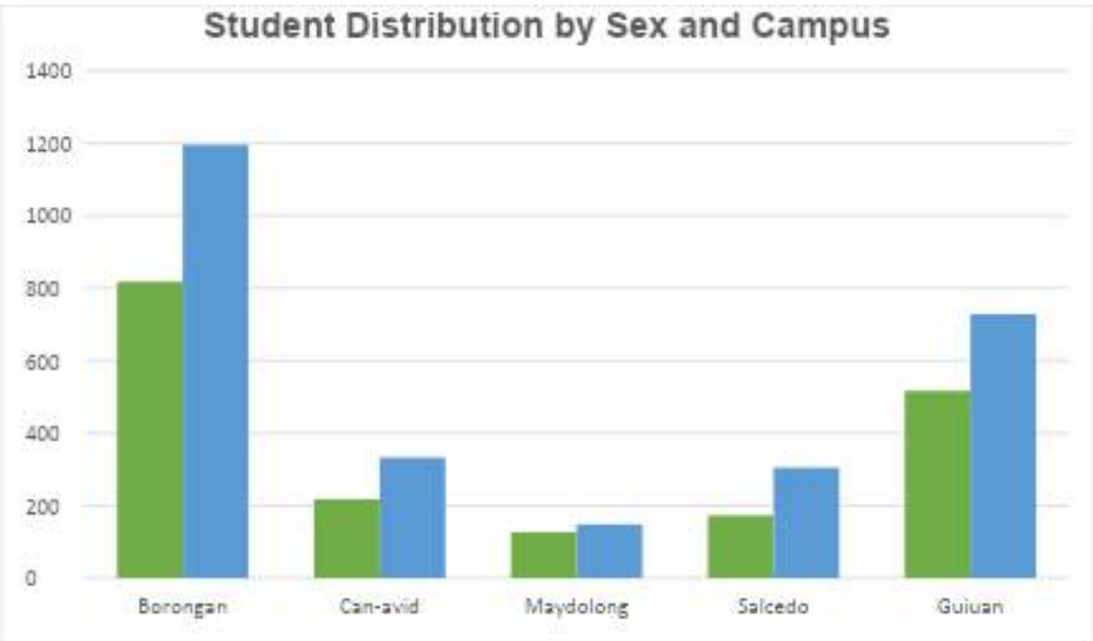
Importantly, tracking women's graduation rate goes beyond determining the number of female students enrolled. It also requires monitoring whether women complete their academic programs at rates comparable to men. Through the systematic collection and analysis of sex-disaggregated academic records, the University can identify potential differences in graduation outcomes and develop appropriate schemes to close any gap.

These efforts reinforce ESSU's commitment to ensuring that women are not only provided access to higher education but are also supported in successfully completing their academic programs. The institutionalization of gender-disaggregated student monitoring contributes to evidence-based decision-making, equitable student support, and the advancement of inclusive and quality higher education.

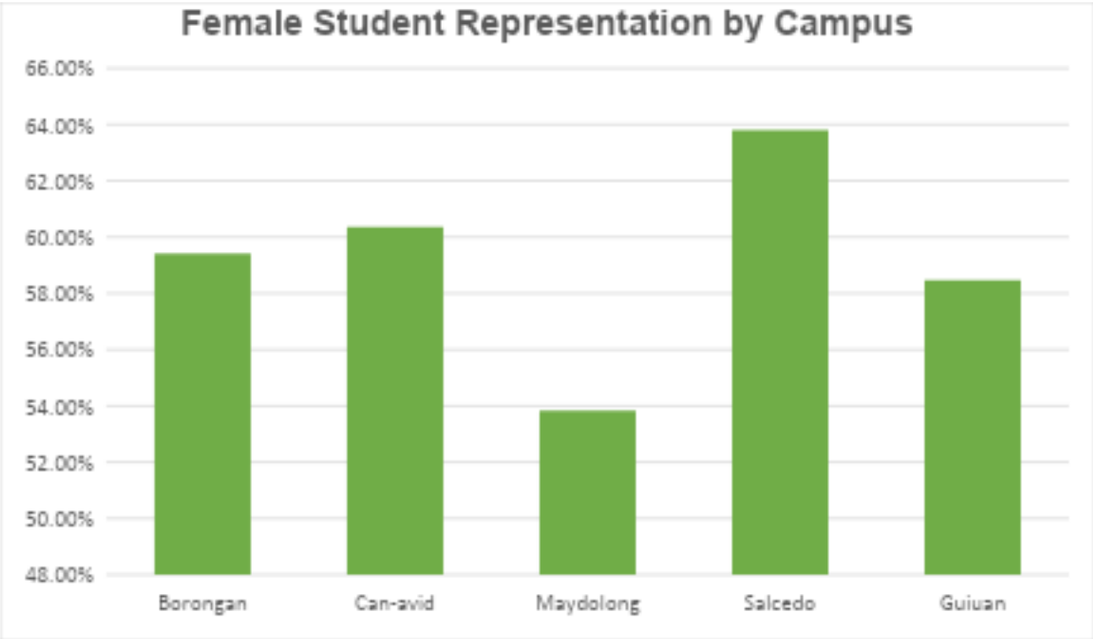
Distribution of Students by Sex and Campus, First Semester SY 2024–2025

Campus	Male	Female	Total	Female (%)
Borongan	817	1,196	2,013	59.41%
Can-avid	218	332	550	60.36%
Maydolong	127	148	275	53.82%
Salcedo	173	305	478	63.81%
Guiuan	517	728	1,245	58.47%
Consolidated	**1,852**	**2,709**	**4,561**	**59.39%**

Male and Female Student Distribution by Sex and Campus



Percentage of Female Students by Campus



Interpretation and Institutional Impact

The data reveal three important observations:

1. **Strong female participation across campuses.** Female students constitute 59.39% of ESSU's consolidated enrollment, indicating substantial representation of women in the University's academic community.
2. **Consistent female representation across campuses.** Women account for more than half of the student population in all five campuses. Salcedo has the highest female representation (63.81%), while Maydolong has the lowest (53.82%). These variations provide useful information for campus-level monitoring and gender-responsive academic planning.
3. **A foundation for monitoring graduation outcomes.** The sex-disaggregated records establish a baseline for comparing the academic progression and eventual completion of female and male students. Such monitoring can help the University identify possible barriers to women's academic completion and determine where additional institutional support may be necessary.

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SUSTAINABLE DEVELOPMENT GOALS

5.6 WOMEN'S PROGRESS MEASURES

5.6.8 POLICIES PROTECTING THOSE REPORTING DISCRIMINATION



5 GENDER EQUALITY

5.6 WOMEN'S PROGRESS MEASURES

5.6.8 POLICIES PROTECTING THOSE REPORTING DISCRIMINATION

Eastern Samar State University (ESSU) demonstrates its institutional commitment to protecting individuals reporting discrimination from educational or employment disadvantage through the establishment of formal institutional procedures, gender-responsive policies, and awareness-raising initiatives. These measures reinforce the University's responsibility to provide a safe, inclusive, and equitable environment where members of the academic community can report incidents of discrimination and sexual harassment without fear of retaliation or adverse consequences.

A significant institutional measure is **Board of Regents (BOR) Resolution No. 175, Series of 2024**, entitled **A Resolution Approving the Procedural Rules of the Committee on Decorum and Investigation (CODI) for Sexual Harassment Cases in Eastern Samar State University (ESSU) Campuses.** This resolution formally approves the procedural rules governing the investigation and handling of sexual harassment cases across ESSU campuses. By institutionalizing the procedures of the Committee on Decorum and Investigation (CODI), the University establishes a formal mechanism for receiving, addressing, and investigating sexual harassment complaints. This provides an institutional framework for ensuring that reported cases are handled through established procedures and that individuals seeking redress have an appropriate channel for reporting their concerns.

Complementing this institutional policy, ESSU implements gender-responsive information and education activities that strengthen awareness of gender equality, discrimination, and the rights and responsibilities of members of the University community.

Among these initiatives is the **Seminar on Gender and Development Policies and PCW Mandates,** which provides an avenue for discussing gender and development policies and the mandates of the Philippine Commission on Women (PCW). Through this seminar, the University strengthens awareness of its gender equality commitments and the institutional responsibilities involved in implementing gender-responsive policies. The initiative supports the development of an informed academic community that recognizes the importance of addressing gender-related concerns and promoting equal treatment.

ESSU further reinforces these efforts through **Memorandum No. 2024-GAD-004**, entitled **Gender Sensitivity Orientation on Basic GAD Concepts**." This orientation promotes understanding of fundamental gender and development concepts and encourages participants to recognize gender-related issues and discriminatory practices. By strengthening gender sensitivity among members of the University community, the initiative contributes to an environment where individuals are more conscious of gender-based discrimination and the importance of respecting the rights and dignity of others.

The University also conducts the activity **Breaking Gender Stereotypes**," which addresses preconceived notions and gender-based expectations that may perpetuate discrimination and unequal treatment. Challenging gender stereotypes is an important component of institutional gender equality efforts because discriminatory attitudes and social norms can create barriers to equal participation and opportunities in education and employment. Through this initiative, ESSU promotes greater awareness of gender biases and encourages more equitable and inclusive interactions within the academic community.

Moreover, ESSU strengthens awareness of legal protections through the ***Seminar on Gender and Development: Safe Spaces Act to 3rd Year, College of Education Students**." This activity introduces students to the provisions and implications of Republic Act No. 11313, or the Safe Spaces Act. By integrating awareness of the law into student-oriented gender and development activities, the University reinforces understanding of protection against gender-based sexual harassment and the importance of maintaining safe and respectful educational environments. The initiative also encourages students to become more informed about their rights, responsibilities, and available mechanisms for addressing gender-based harassment.

Collectively, these measures demonstrate that ESSU's efforts to protect individuals reporting discrimination are supported by both formal institutional procedures and continuing gender-responsive education. BOR Resolution No. 175, s. 2024 provides the institutional foundation through the approved CODI procedural rules, while the GAD seminar, Gender Sensitivity Orientation, Breaking Gender Stereotypes activity, and Safe Spaces Act seminar reinforce awareness and understanding of gender equality, discriminatory practices, and mechanisms for addressing sexual harassment.

The impact of these initiatives extends beyond the establishment of formal procedures. By strengthening institutional mechanisms and increasing awareness among students and personnel, ESSU contributes to reducing barriers to reporting discrimination, encouraging informed participation in institutional protection mechanisms, and fostering a culture of accountability and respect. These efforts are particularly important in ensuring that individuals who report discrimination are not discouraged from seeking assistance because of fear of educational or employment disadvantage.

For the 2022–2026 assessment period, ESSU confirms that the relevant policies and provisions were created within the prescribed period. Documentary evidence is provided through BOR Resolution No. 175, s. 2024, Memorandum No. 2024-GAD-004, and documentation of the University's gender and development activities. The evidence is publicly accessible, allowing external stakeholders to verify the University's policy commitments and supporting initiatives.

Through these institutional policies and activities, Eastern Samar State University demonstrates its commitment to the THE indicator requirement to **"Have a policy that protects those reporting discrimination from educational or employment disadvantage."** These

initiatives contribute to advancing gender equality by strengthening institutional accountability, promoting awareness of protective mechanisms, and fostering a safe, equitable, and inclusive educational and working environment across its campuses.

Summary of documentary evidence

The following table identifies the policies and activities supporting ESSU's compliance with the indicator and includes link to evidence.

Policy / Activity	Institutional Contribution
BOR Resolution No. 175, s. 2024 – Approval of the Procedural Rules of CODI for Sexual Harassment Cases in ESSU Campuses	Establishes formal institutional procedures for handling sexual harassment complaints across ESSU campuses.
Seminar on Gender and Development Policies and PCW Mandates	Strengthens awareness of GAD policies and the mandates of the Philippine Commission on Women.
Memorandum No. 2024-GAD-004 – Gender Sensitivity Orientation on Basic GAD Concepts	Promotes gender sensitivity and understanding of gender-related concerns and discrimination.
Breaking Gender Stereotypes	Addresses gender stereotypes and discriminatory attitudes that contribute to unequal treatment.
Seminar on Gender and Development: Safe Spaces Act to 3rd Year, College of Education Students	Promotes awareness of RA 11313 and protection against gender-based sexual harassment.

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SUSTAINABLE DEVELOPMENT GOALS

5.6 WOMEN'S PROGRESS MEASURES

5.6.9 PATERNITY POLICY



5 GENDER EQUALITY

5.6 WOMEN'S PROGRESS MEASURES

5.6.9 PATERNITY POLICY

Eastern Samar State University (ESSU) has an institutional policy on paternity leave that supports women's participation by ensuring that fathers can participate in childcare duties and share family responsibilities during childbirth and the immediate postnatal period. The policy is stipulated in the University's **Human Resource Management Office (HRMO) Operations Manual, Version 1**, under Section 10.5 (Paternity Leave), demonstrating the University's commitment to recognizing the role of fathers in family care and promoting a more equitable distribution of childcare responsibilities.

Under Section 10.5.1, paternity leave is a privilege granted to a married male employee, allowing him not to report for work for seven days when his legitimate spouse has delivered or suffered a miscarriage. Furthermore, Section 10.5.2 provides that every married male employee is entitled to **seven working days of paternity leave for the first four deliveries** of his legitimate spouse with whom he is cohabiting. Section 10.5.3 also clarifies the entitlement of married male employees with more than one spouse, subject to an absolute maximum of four deliveries, regardless of which spouse gives birth.

The policy further provides flexibility in the utilization of paternity leave. As stipulated in Section 10.5.4, paternity leave may be enjoyed either continuously or intermittently on the days immediately before, during, and after the childbirth of the employee's legitimate spouse. Section 10.5.5 requires the accomplishment of an Application for Leave by the concerned employee, establishing the administrative procedure for availing of this benefit.

By providing seven working days of paternity leave and allowing its utilization on a continuous or intermittent basis, ESSU enables fathers to participate actively in childcare and provide support to their spouses during childbirth and recovery. This arrangement helps promote shared parental responsibilities, recognizes childcare as a responsibility of both parents, and supports women employees and spouses in balancing family responsibilities with their participation in employment and other professional activities.

The University's paternity leave policy therefore demonstrates an institutional measure that supports gender equality within the workplace and family setting. By formally recognizing fathers' participation in childcare, ESSU contributes to addressing the unequal distribution of unpaid care and domestic responsibilities, which can affect women's opportunities for employment, professional development, and continued participation in the workforce.

The University provides the following supporting documents:

1. Human Resource Management Office Operations Manual, Version 1– Section 10.5 (Paternity Leave), particularly Sections 10.5.1 to 10.5.5, which establish the eligibility, duration, conditions, and procedures for availing of paternity leave.
   HRMO Manual
2. Sample Application for Leave Form with Paternity Leave – This demonstrates the administrative mechanism through which eligible male employees may formally request and avail of the benefit.



Civil Service Form No. 6
Revised 2020

Republic of the Philippines
(EASTERN SAMAR STATE UNIVERSITY)
(Borongan City, Eastern Samar)

Stamp of Date of Receipt

APPLICATION FOR LEAVE

1. OFFICE/DEPARTMENT | 2. NAME: (Last) (First) (Middle)
CASS / IZN

3. DATE OF FILING | 4. POSITION | 5. SALARY

6. DETAILS OF APPLICATION

6.A TYPE OF LEAVE TO BE AVAILED OF
- ☐ Vacation Leave (Sec. 51, Rule XVI, Omnibus Rules Implementing E.O. No. 292)
- ☐ Mandatory/Forced Leave (Sec. 25, Rule XVI, Omnibus Rules Implementing E.O. No. 292)
- ☐ Sick Leave (Sec. 43, Rule XVI, Omnibus Rules Implementing E.O. No. 292)
- ☐ Maternity Leave (R.A. No. 11210 / IRR issued by CSC, DOLE and SSS)
- ☑ Paternity Leave (R.A. No. 8187 / CSC MC No. 71, s. 1998, as amended)
- ☐ Special Privilege Leave (Sec. 21, Rule XVI, Omnibus Rules Implementing E.O. No. 292)
- ☐ Solo Parent Leave (RA No. 8972 / CSC MC No. 8, s. 2004)
- ☐ Study Leave (Sec. 68, Rule XVI, Omnibus Rules Implementing E.O. No. 292)
- ☐ 10-Day VAWC Leave (RA No. 9262 / CSC MC No. 15, s. 2005)
- ☐ Rehabilitation Privilege (Sec. 55, Rule XVI, Omnibus Rules Implementing E.O. No. 292)
- ☐ Special Leave Benefits for Women (RA No. 9710 / CSC MC No. 25, s. 2010)
- ☐ Special Emergency (Calamity) Leave (CSC MC No. 2, s. 2012, as amended)
- ☐ Adoption Leave (R.A. No. 8552)

Others:

6.B DETAILS OF LEAVE
In case of Vacation/Special Privilege Leave:
- ☑ Within the Philippines
- ☐ Abroad (Specify)

In case of Sick Leave:
- ☐ In Hospital (Specify Illness)
- ☐ Out Patient (Specify Illness)

In case of Special Leave Benefits for Women:
(Specify Illness)

In case of Study Leave:
- ☐ Completion of Master's Degree
- ☐ BAR/Board Examination Review

Other purpose:
- ☐ Monetization of Leave Credits
- ☐ Terminal Leave

6.C NUMBER OF WORKING DAYS APPLIED FOR

6.D COMMUTATION
- ☐ Not Requested
- ☐ Requested

(Signature of Applicant)

7. DETAILS OF ACTION ON APPLICATION

7.A CERTIFICATION OF LEAVE CREDITS
As of _____

	Vacation Leave	Sick Leave
Total Earned		
Less this application		
Balance		

(Name & Signature of Authorized Officer)

7.B RECOMMENDATION
- ☐ For approval
- ☐ For disapproval due to: _____

(Name & Signature of Authorized Officer)

7.C APPROVED FOR:
_____ days with pay
_____ days without pay
_____ others (Specify)

7.D DISAPPROVED DUE TO:

Date _____

Name and Signature of Authorized Official

The policy was created in 2022, within the 2022–2026 assessment period. The supporting policy document and sample leave application form are publicly available, providing verifiable evidence of the University's institutional commitment to supporting women's participation by ensuring that fathers can participate in childcare duties.

Through this policy, ESSU institutionalizes a workplace provision that encourages shared parenting and strengthens the University's contribution to gender equality and the recognition of unpaid care and domestic work.